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Virginia Board of Education, Work Session, Wednesday, March 22, 2023

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uI8vQmvgjXg
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-23. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:09:12] Good morning, everyone. I'm going to call the meeting of the Board of Education to order as soon as I can get the rest of the board to be quiet over there. Okay. Dr. Mann. I move, pursuant to Virginia Code 2.2-3711A1, the Virginia Board of Education convene in a closed meeting for the purpose of discussion, consideration or interviews of prospective candidates for employment assignment appointment promotion performance demotion salaries disciplining or resignation of specific public

[00:09:48] officers appointees or employees of any public body specifically a high level department employee do we have emotions there a second uh all in favor signify by saying aye hi okay we're going

[00:10:03] going to move into executive session and we'll certify when we come back uh coming back into

[00:49:12] open session give me just a second guys all right uh dr man let me actually first note that we have with us a new board member we're delighted to welcome dale sterthin uh from mecklenburg to the board we'll say more about that actually tomorrow at the real meeting you know the bigger meeting uh you know the work session meeting or the business meeting excuse me of the board uh note that he was not here when we went into closed session but he has been appointed by the governor to fill the uh last slot on the board and has signed the oath and so we are ready to roll

[00:49:50] dr mann okay mr president we convene today in a closed meeting pursuant to a recorded vote on the On the motion above and in accordance with the Freedom of Information Act section 2.2-3712 of the Code of Virginia requires that the board certify that, to the best of each member's knowledge, one, only public business matters lawfully exempt from open meeting requirements under this chapter, and two, only such public business matters as were identified in the

[00:50:24] motion by which the closed meeting was convened were heard discussed or considered any member who believes there was a departure from these requirements shall so state prior to the vote including the substance of the departure that in his or her judgment has taken place the statement of the departure will be recorded in the minutes we'll certify this by roll call and the certification is just everybody understands that no business other than that lawfully allowed

[00:50:55] occurred in the closed session. Ms. Creasy, Ms. Halton, Dr. Siebert, Dr. Mann, Mr. Hansen, Mr. Sturdifant, and Mr. Rotherham. Thank you. All right, Dr. Mann, we will, for purpose of licensure hearings, we'll go into closed session. Dr. Mann. I move that pursuant to Virginia Code 2.2-3711 A40, the Virginia Board of Education convene in a closed meeting for the purpose of

[00:51:33] discussion and consideration of records relating to denial, suspension, or revocation of teacher licenses and pursue it to Virginia Code 2.2-3711 A7 to consult with counsel and receive legal advice regarding the same and that deborah love legal counsel to the virginia board of education as well as the following staff members dr joan b johnson angela schneider and stephen urkoth

[00:52:08] whose presence will aid the board perhaps you might want to add abby gump yes and abby gump gump with the attorney general's office with the ag's office whose presence will aid in the board's consideration of this matter participate in the closed meeting we have a motion is there a second uh all those in favor signify by saying aye aye okay we're going to move to closed session um

[00:52:35] by the closed session dr mann we convened today in a closed meeting pursuant to a recorded vote

[02:27:57] on the motion above and in accordance with the freedom of information act section 2.23712 of the code of virginia requires that the board certify that to the best of each member's knowledge one only public business matters lawfully exempt from open meeting requirements under this chapter and two only such public business matters as were identified in the motion by which the closed session meeting was convened were heard discussed or considered any member who believes there was a departure from these requirements shall so stay prior to the vote indicating the substance of the

[02:28:37] departure that in his or her judgment has taken place the statement of the departure will be recorded in the minutes okay we will certify by roll call again miss creasy uh miss halton aye dr siebert aye dr mann aye mr hanson aye mr sturdivant aye uh mr rotherham aye and chair votes aye. Chair will entertain a license or a motion to issue a license in case one.

[02:29:03] There a motion? So moved. Second. Thank you. That's been moved and seconded again by roll call. Ms. Creasy? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Siebert? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. Mr. Hanson? Aye. Mr. Sturdifant? Aye.

[02:29:20] Mr. Rotherham? Aye. And chair votes aye. Chair will entertain a motion to revoke the license of Wilson Taylor IV. So moved. Thank you, Dr. Siebert. Is there a second? Second. Thank you. again by roll call. Ms. Creasy? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Siebert? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. Mr. Hanson? Aye.

[02:29:39] Mr. Sturdifant? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. And chair votes aye. Entertain a motion to revoke the license of Andrew Prestel Henson? So moved. Second. Thank you. Ms. Creasy? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Siebert? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. Mr. Hanson? Aye. Mr. Sturdifant? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye.

[02:30:02] and chair votes i entertain a motion to revoke the license of matthew joseph snell so moved thank you is there a second okay thank you uh miss creasy miss holton aye uh dr siebert aye uh dr mann aye mr hanson all right mr sturdifant aye mr rotherham aye and chair votes aye that was that was snell yes thank you uh chair will entertain a motion to issue a license in case five thank you miss creasy is there a second second thank you dr man miss creasy hi miss

[02:30:38] halton hi dr siebert hi dr man hi mr hanson hi mr sturdifant hi mr rotherham hi and chair votes i will entertain a motion to revoke the license of daniel ormond king thank you miss creasy and

[02:30:53] Dr. Siebert, Ms. Creasy, Ms. Halton, Dr. Siebert, Dr. Mann, Mr. Hansen, Mr. Sturdeffin, Mr. Rotherham, and chair votes aye. We'll entertain a motion to issue a license in case number seven. Is there a second? Second. Thank you, Dr. Mann. Ms. Creasy, Ms. Halton, Dr. Siebert, Dr. Mann, Mr. Hansen, Mr. Sturdeffin, Mr. Rotherham, and chair chair votes aye. We'll entertain a motion to issue a two-year extension of the respondent's

[02:31:32] license in case eight pursuant to House Bill 236. So moved. Thank you, Dr. Siebert. Second. Thank you. Ms. Creasy. Aye. Ms. Holton. Aye. Dr. Siebert. Aye. Dr. Mann. Aye. Mr. Hansen. Aye. Mr. Sturdifant. Aye. And Mr. Rotherham. Aye. And chair votes aye. Issue a motion to revoke the license of Joseph richard nowak the third so moved second second thank you um miss creasy hi miss holton hi dr siebert hi dr mann hi mr hanson all right mr certifan hi mr rotherham hi and chair votes aye

[02:32:09] i believe that concludes the business of the board for the morning uh we are having noticed lunch session and followed by an afternoon work session thank you all we stand in recess what time is our

[02:32:21] noticed at lunch for i don't know jim anybody what time are we noticed for everybody we have uh

[05:37:57] two new faces up on the desk uh first i will introduce uh our newest board member very happy to have dale stern from mecklenburg uh and again we're welcome to make comments now but tomorrow will be the meeting at which it would be most appropriate because that's sort of the business meeting of the board but we're happy to have you and uh you know we're looking forward it's it's good for me and for the board to finally be back at full strength so thank you i'll wait until tomorrow for comments okay and uh i'm particularly delighted to have with us k cole james secretary

[05:38:32] of the commonwealth an old friend and uh incredibly accomplished human being uh you know i guess representing uh the executive branch here at the meeting and uh we are delighted thank you

[05:38:45] you so much. We are honored. Thank you for having me. Okay. First item on the agenda. Proposed revisions to the current accreditation system for 2023-24. President Gecker and honorable members of the board, Secretary James. I'm going to just kick it off briefly and then hand it over to Shelly and Amy so that we can dive into our presentation today. Let me just ask you before you start. Yes, sir. I interrupted you for a reason because I saw you interrupt 69 people in Williamsburg the other day.

[05:39:19] wanted you to understand how it felt every time one of those people hit two minutes and somebody said time thank you for that president gecker thanks for bringing that up yes it was an

incredibly effective it was awesome but now you've got them yes sir now i know personally yes sir thanks um so of course we are picking up on our conversation on accountability today and as as you will recall at the february meeting we presented a very detailed path forward a two-year plan to transform our current accreditation system to decouple it and create a standalone accountability and a

[05:39:59] standalone accreditation system as a part of that overall two-year process what we presented to you is what we called phase one changes so immediate changes that the board could make under their current statutory and regulatory authority to address some of the board's overall concerns with the current accreditation system so we have that the phase one part of the process to present to you today um shelley and amy have worked incredibly hard um getting us here and i'm so

[05:40:33] appreciative of their work um i do want to let the board know um i'm actually waiting on a visitor right now um one of the issues that has come up over the last several months um the board has encouraged us to consult with external experts and so i wanted to update the board and let you all know that we have contracted with two individuals to assist in this process uh and high slop uh who you all know who has presented to this board previously um and she's on her way and was supposed to be here today so she'll be joining us shortly as soon as she gets here and then the

[05:41:04] The other contractor is Chad Adelman, who most of you may know, has worked with Andy before and with others and is a well-known national expert on accountability systems. And so he is also helping us. He was supposed to be here today as well, but had a last-minute trip to Denver.

[05:41:21] So those are two individuals that you will see throughout the course of the next several months. They're going to be working closely with our team, and we think that they're going to be a great value add to this process. i did not know chad was under contract he's terrific he's also a virginia public school parent has two kids in public schools yeah great so i will pass it off to you amy to pick up shelly did you want to make anything all right well good afternoon president gecker vice president man and board members today i will be presenting the phase one changes to our accreditation system

[05:41:54] phase one will be implemented in fall of 2024 based on the 2324 school year data phase one is a transitional stage that's part of the department's overall plan to reform the accountability model right so i'll start out by providing a contextual information that will help drive the conversation today the background information will also help those who are watching the work session online

[05:42:29] and will help our new board members it will include the reasons behind the accountability reformation a review of the structure of the bifurcated model the overall timeline and how phase one fits into it and then finally the phase one changes that the board currently has the authority to make under the statutory and regulatory regulations one of the governor's education goals is the creation of a best-in-class accountability system based on high expectations

[05:43:09] for all students that's easily understood by all stakeholders the accountability system must provide a transparent accurate reflection of student mastery of essential knowledge and skills especially within at-risk student groups having an accurate reflection of student performance will help shine a light on areas that are in need of improvement and allow the department to just better support schools one of the concerns with the current accreditation system is that it does

[05:43:44] not provide a complete picture of school and student performance because the accreditation system uses a combined rate at the middle and elementary schools the accreditation results for those

schools do not represent the number of students who demonstrate proficiency so if you look at the bottom chart that has the yellowish orange header you can see there are several schools listed down the left hand side and you can see the accreditation combined rates for those schools and then you can see the actual pass rates of those schools and you can see there's

[05:44:23] quite a bit of variability in those pass rates as compared compared to the accreditation combined rate and of course the concern is is that combined rate masks the performance levels of schools of students on the assessments the other concern that has been voiced is the percent of schools that were accredited in 22-23 is very similar to the percent of schools that were accredited in

[05:44:57] 2019-20 and that was the pre-pandemic so even though the schools were facing significant learning loss during the the pandemic and we also saw a drop in sol scores and nape scores that is not really reflected in the 22-23 accreditation ratings um and there's just not a lot of differentiation between um school performance uh proficiency and the uh accreditation ratings that

[05:45:34] Yeah, if I have questions on that slide, would you prefer that I hold them to the end or ask them now? Or does Mr. President, do you have a question? You can go ahead and ask them now.

[05:45:50] So, I have two questions. One is, I thought I heard you say that there was not a significant difference from 1920 to 2223, I'm seeing credited with conditions, which is the schools, the Office of School Quality must be focusing on and working with more intensely, went up from 132 to 190.

[05:46:12] By my math, that's a 40 plus percent increase. So I guess that's one. Am I missing something in the data is part of the question. and the other part of that question is help me understand why having a pandemic that had huge impact no doubt about it on learning loss why should that change a school's why would we why would our theory of change suggest that should change a school's accreditation status to me accreditation means does the school is the school doing what it should be doing to serve

[05:46:46] students well that's what accreditation means at the higher ed level it's uh what the terminology is understood to mean in the private school sector in the public school sector i don't understand why when a national phenomenon like a pandemic causes learning loss that should mean why do we think that should make more schools not accredited or accredited with conditions so um i i the concern with the percent that is accredited is the accreditation status should really represent

[05:47:23] how schools are performing on on different indicators one of the indicators um that we have of course is that combined rate but that combined rate includes various components so it masks for some schools not all schools but for some schools it masks the student performance level and certainly that's something that needs critical eye when we're faced with something like the pandemic and we're looking at students proficiency levels on the standards and where

[05:47:58] they are so in the in the past when schools are looking at whether they're meeting the benchmarks whether they're you know what kind of um improvement they need to make if for instance if we looked at um on that example on that bottom chart and say we looked at i don't know school b in math where they have an 82 percent combined rate which gave them a level one which is a green you know that's the the interface that the community sees that doesn't have the appearance

[05:48:38] that that's an issue where students or schools need to focus but when you actually look at the annual pass rate for that particular school it was 40 so certainly that is an area that that school needs to focus on so i think the concern is even with all of that learning loss that has occurred our system the way it

is set up now with the combined rate isn't really differentiating between the school they got a 40 annual pass rate and school c which had the 93 pass rate

[05:49:12] so i'm not if i can move to my next question well can we talk about i think this is an important i think because i support too i agree with miss holden that like why would you want an accreditation system that changes that rapid but that's the whole problem we don't have any other way to communicate with parents what's going on that's why we're talking about how do we build an accountability system so we don't have chaos around accreditation but we do have honest communication about what's going on because i mean the should the pandemic cause like a bunch of schools not to be accredited i think we probably generally agree no but should it cause like a fair amount of

[05:49:47] attention and alarm about kids who have been left behind yes and this doesn't get us there so it's less about uh this particular system more about what we need and we simply we don't have an an accountability system. My understanding is that's what we're driving towards. There'll have to be some changes to accreditation as a result of that, but we're driving towards what's a meaningful accountability and communication system for parents to deploy resources, all of that, that that's the ballgame that we're talking about. Certainly, Andy, deploying resources is part of it, but first of all, let me say I agree with the first point entirely. I mean, there is no reason

[05:50:22] in my mind to think that when you have a series of years when the kids aren't in school and don't perform well to automatically assume that when those kids go back, I mean, that those, the same schools that were teaching well before the pandemic aren't teaching well after the pandemic. I mean, the virtual education didn't work so well, right? And we know that, but there was plenty of data to demonstrate that we have the learning laws piece. So again, I think back to Ms. Holton's question, And why would we say that all of a sudden, you know, a school teaching well pre-pandemic

[05:51:00] as virtual for the year, year and a half, whatever it ended up being, has the learning laws that post-pandemic, we don't think they're teaching well. I don't understand the logic there. And in terms of driving resources, Andy, I mean, we know all the underlying data now, right?

[05:51:20] And there are a couple purposes to the accreditation accountability system. One may be to inform parents, although that data is available. It may be to inform them in a way that's easier to understand, but we can talk about that. Part of it ought to be, in my view, how do we create systemic incentives so that schools focus on what we want them to focus on?

[05:51:44] And I'll give you the example that I know nobody likes anymore, but the reason, as an example, we put chronic absenteeism in last time was because we saw among the divisions schools were not focusing on the 25% of the kids who that didn't matter to their accreditation, right? They just, they were falling through the cracks. And we wanted a way to say, you've got to focus on all your kids, not just the kids who are going to count towards you're getting accreditation. And so that was a systemic change that got made.

[05:52:19] You know, I would like to talk about this in terms not only of how do we inform our parents, But how do we use the accreditation system to incentivize the locals to do what they ought to be doing for all of their kids? And I fear sometimes that gets that piece of it, the incentive, you know, the systemic incentives piece gets lost.

[05:52:40] There's no doubt that when Dr. Siebert was a superintendent, he cared about getting his schools accredited and would set up systems in his division in order to cause that to happen. what that means to me is that we need to devise the system to incentivize him to do what's best for those kids that we need the most benefit but i would also take issue with the idea that maybe there's 25 of our children we weren't paying attention to so again we we we try we always try to and we even in our documents try to you know uh be understanding so that i i think actually we're all on the same page here because i think your question gets at the reason why we need to

[05:53:16] separate the systems. Because if accreditation is going to be about the inputs and is your board, is your locality meeting the SOQ and fulfilling the requirements outlined in the code and in the regulations by the board, that should be a checkbox. And so that wouldn't change during a pandemic because you're doing what you're supposed to do. But again, accountability would be reporting how students are doing. And then you would see the student decline. I think that's kind of that so there's two parts there's the separating accountability and accreditation then within your question and and uh back to the answer um was is the combined rate uh you know

[05:53:55] how how clearly uh do people understand that and is there better ways to represent that but i i agree that accreditation should not be this wild ride that just this pendulum swings widely it should it should be um about thoughtful governance and leadership at the division at the school level to have your school as accredited, but you could be accredited and still not getting good results. And so that's where the accountability piece would be separate and more clear, I hope.

[05:54:21] Can I just make a comment? So just if you would look at that 40% that was picked out there, and then you look at the 82%, oftentimes a school's going to see that 82%, and what's that going to tell them. We're doing fine, right? That doesn't incentivize them to do more at the school level, whereas that 40% number would incentivize action, right? We are at 40%. We've got to act

[05:54:56] here. You know, I think the other point that I'd like to make here is that I don't think any of us are saying that teachers are not teaching well post-pandemic. I think that what we are saying is that teachers have to teach differently because we've had some really big shifts in what we have to do to get kids back to where they need to be. And so that has to be recognized for a number of things. And most of all, identification of those interventions that are needed to get us out of that 40%. And so we've got to do a lot more of that identification of those needs that

[05:55:36] kids have on this end of the pandemic and really resource that. So do you think that we will have additional resource needs for what you might call the COVID cohort, that almost a balloon going through the system now that comes back down to, you know, you almost, in a sense, have to separate out the needs created by COVID, you know, the learning loss needs from the generalized needs of the system in a normal operating year, right? Because the kids coming into kindergarten, right, post-COVID, they ought to have your basic, you know, K-12 education without the impact. Well,

[05:56:15] I don't want to talk about the pre-K impact of COVID. I don't want to, but you understand that. You understand the point. I understand that. Sorry. You know, are we changing this instead of looking at what resources ought to be dedicated to the COVID cohort? And will this cause those resources to be dedicated? You know, one of the things we've talked about a lot is, you know, we can change these systems all we want. I mean, all this data is available if somebody knows where to look for it. And again, I think

most superintendents, most principals understand they don't look at the combined rate. They look at how each of their kids is doing, right?

[05:56:50] This may be good for public presentation, but at the school level, this is not what they're looking at. And are we, in a sense, masking the issue of provision of resources by focusing on this high level of accreditation accountability stuff, instead of saying, you know, we know we've got a lot of kids behind because of COVID. What are the meaningful steps we can take? And I know, you know, they've announced partnerships and tutoring and, you know, but maybe we ought to think about, is there something more systematic that ought to be done to deal with the COVID

[05:57:27] cohort, which has got, I wouldn't say a one-time cost to it, but essentially a quantifiable cost going through the system. And then tinker separately in a sense with, because I'm not arguing to keep the combined rate. It's something that I never really understood either. So as a parent, I would say, yeah, that doesn't mean anything to me. But I'm not sure that masking is really the issue. I don't think the data among educators is lacking. I think everybody knows where we are. And frankly, I think most schools know where each of their kids are. Would that be fair? I would disagree with that. Well, I've got a former practitioner here. Well, how often do you

[05:58:05] see school divisions report i mean we we hear about overall pass rates and we hear about accreditation how often do you hear them report about gaps about this aggregation we talk a lot around here about all the time they talk about it all the time at local school boards i so i'm not going to start naming divisions on this dais but i can think of one in particular that serves a lot of kids in this commonwealth that made a point of saying don't even pay attention to this with the sol stuff don't pay attention to the nate that's all just people trying to stir things up everything's okay the superintendent said this in an in an open meeting and a superintendent's memo i mean i think look we can we can go round and round on this right now i think this system first

[05:58:44] of all it does make kids invisible like just the mechanics of it the the with the pass rates it takes for accreditation the lack of disaggregation in some cases it makes kids invisible we had a presentation on that recently by miss heislop um and then second i do think parents are largely flying blind and and let's take it one step further andy let's assume that you're right okay and you put in place a system that unmasks the kids then what flows from that i mean i don't believe your premise is correct that is i think more people in the system understand how badly

[05:59:18] things have gone recently but what is the fix then you know it's one thing for the parents to know but uh if you go back to the 95 changes in the accreditation system right the theory was resources would follow but you still had the same schools during poorly 20 years later right resources didn't follow so what i want to talk about a little bit is before we change the system and i'm not averse to changing the system what are what resources will flow from the now unmasked data so every parent in the commonwealth knows my kids aren't doing my kid isn't doing well

[05:59:55] what are you going to do about it what are we going to do about it i would actually say though that resources have flowed and time and time again from the federal government the title one programs the biggest programs massive increases double increases 20 years ago with no child left behind exponential increases these last two or three years with the covid funding so i think that is not an accurate assessment so and i would agree with andy that we we need to have the system in

[06:00:26] place. And I'm having a hard time even understanding why we wouldn't want those local leaders to have more transparent data, more meaningful data, in addition to the parents, and I think in addition to the policymakers, to be able to drive the resources where they're most needed. The governor just said that to us this morning. And I think it's critically important if it's, again, a doctor diagnosing a patient, you don't know where to apply and what to apply and how to apply it unless you know where the challenges are.

[06:01:01] If I may, I just, I mean, the pass rates are all on the school quality profile, so the data is all out there. To the resource question, you know, we in Virginia, unlike in some other states, don't direct any extra financial resources, if I'm correct, and help me if I'm wrong, to schools that are accredited with conditions.

[06:01:24] And I will say, I appreciate the talk about accreditation versus accountability, But to me, I don't care what we call it, the system that we use to identify our most challenged schools upon whom we're going to impose additional scrutiny and additional expectations and resources and resources.

[06:01:44] But we don't in Virginia steer resources to them. The only resource we steer to them currently is essentially oversight through the Office of School Quality. And right now, before the pandemic, that office was serving 132 schools.

[06:02:01] And JLARC found that they were not well enough staffed to handle 132 schools. And post-pandemic, they were handling 190 schools, so a 40%-plus increase. They've had little tiny increases in staffing, but nothing major.

[06:02:19] There's nothing, I don't think, in either of the budgets under current consideration of the General Assembly, neither. None of the governor's budget, nor the House, nor the Senate budget staffs up that OSQ, that Office of School Quality, nor does anybody steer extra financial resources to those schools themselves.

[06:02:38] So, you know, if we're going to, you know, how many of our schools can we effectively intervene with? 190 is, you know, what percentage is of that of our 1,800 schools? It's 200 of our 1,800 schools. It's not an infinitesimal percentage.

[06:02:56] And to me, the notion that because we had a pandemic, we should suddenly be imposing additional scrutiny on more schools. We should be imposing additional scrutiny across the board to address learning loss. Absolutely. But to me, the most important role, and there are lots of roles, but the most important role of our accountability system, whether you call it accreditation or call it accountability, is driving change.

[06:03:22] And driving change, especially, and I know Andy's seen the research, but accountability systems are most effective in driving change at the bottom end of the spectrum. and therefore you know this question of the schools that we're identifying for extra scrutiny is just crucial and so i come back to the question of why do we think a pandemic would all of us if we've thought before that approximately 200 of our 1800 schools needed extra scrutiny why do we suddenly think i mean the pandemic means all of them need extra scrutiny but why should we be singling out more relatively i feel yeah i hear and then i'm sorry if i can just go to my one more

[06:03:59] question and then i'll get it off we stay on this point though before your question well the other question is related so if i may that uh am i correct that those annual pass rate you know when you're

looking at the 40 annual pass rate the only reason that school would have a combined rate that we're to level one is because they've got some really phenomenal growth going on there so that's what's adding to the 40 their proficiency isn't good but their growth is through the rope And they can't continue to stay level one based on that unless they get proficient over time.

[06:04:34] In other words, you can't, there's a time limit. You can only be level one based on that 40% proficiency for a year or two. It's built in. And this new system, this system is new enough that because of the pandemic, it really, we've never gotten to years two and three and four.

[06:04:53] The system that went into effect in 1819 got turned topsy-turvy with the pandemic. And Amy and Shelly can help me phrase it correctly or tell me if I'm wrong. But am I right that that 40% school, it's not going to be level one again next year.

[06:05:10] The combined rate will stay the same, but the number of years you can stay in the we're growing well, but we're not proficient category is time limited. So last year, when they were determining growth, there was two different ways that a student could show growth.

[06:05:30] They could show growth from the previous spring to the current spring, or they could have shown it from the fall assessment to the spring assessment, the fall growth assessment to the spring SOL test. So there were two different ways.

[06:05:47] There is an item in front of the board that will be brought before the board tomorrow to talk about how we would measure growth this current year. If we were to go do year-to-year growth only, which is what will be proposed to you all tomorrow, the statement that you're making is correct, that there would be just a certain...

[06:06:12] Okay, but maybe the thing I'm talking about is maybe it isn't how the growth rate folds into the combined rate. it's how the schools can't stay level two forever without slipping into level three there's a time limit on how long you can be level two yes shelly knows what i'm talking about so this does beg one question i think the biggest problem with our current system is it's too complex and that's my excuse for not remembering the details so there really are two issues one is there is a rule that a school cannot stay at level two for more than four years and it gets progressively harder and

[06:06:50] then it then it has to become level three i think the other thing you're referencing in terms of growth is if we go back to the year-to-year model of growth that we used previously a student can only show growth for three years and then that student has to reach proficiency so there really are two different time limits one at the student level thank you based on the way we calculate growth and then also this rule within that you all adopted within the soa and am i right that these examples are all essentially at the beginning in other words we haven't ever gotten to years two

[06:07:26] and three and four of that system because the pandemic interrupted us well we have gotten to the subsequent years based on the soa rule it's hard to know where these students are in terms of their progression with growth i mean i think we certainly all know that we saw more growth post pandemic than we did before because obviously we had more students who failed and in virginia you know we just look at growth if the student fails and what is the amount of growth we keep

[06:07:59] talking about growth like what are we actually talking about like how much growth does a student have to make for it to be considered growth and so right now we use a vertical scale and there are eight ranges one of those ranges are failing ranges and the student has to move at least one range in order

to be considered to have made growth in practical terms like what does that mean for for if we're trying if i'm trying to explain that to a parent or a lay person what

[06:08:35] does that mean um i'm trying to help sure our growth measures do not easily our growth measures are are a huge challenge that we need to address someday and that would be something that this board going forward would be and the department would be really wise to focus on the the um ranges have been correlated to descriptions of the level of support that a student would need

[06:09:12] so for instance a student that was at um in the range one there's a description talking about the the significant help that that student would need to to meet proficiency or the or the standards and then there's just um variated descriptions between one and and four um so what's the minimal amount i guess that's what people are wondering what's the minimal amount it varies it varies based on where the student falls on the vertical scale so um for example a student who's scoring

[06:09:50] lower is probably going to have to move more scale score points but it does vary depending on where the student was so the way we do this is we look to see first if the students fail their sol test in the spring and we look back to the previous spring and see whether or not they moved um at least one one range or one level there's a little bit more background originally these ranges were set up based on the performance levels on the sol test so we have four performance levels for grades three through eight reading and math um below basic basic proficient and advanced and so those

[06:10:30] original ranges were set up by taking the performance levels below basic for example taking the median of the distribution and dividing it into sub levels does that help yes so i guess i guess what i'm trying to get at is there a scenario we heard that you could have a 50 56 path rate for instance and an 88 combined rate and that's through the roof growth is that actually the case or could you get there with relatively minimal growth? This past year was a bit different

[06:11:05] because as Amy described, we had two different ways of making growth. And so I think we probably had more growth than normal for a couple of reasons. One, more kids fail because of the pandemic. But secondly, because they could show growth either from the spring to spring comparison or the fall growth assessment to the spring assessment. I think that probably caused us to have a greater amount of growth. Would you agree on this?

[06:11:32] And that means that this is an unusually large gap, at least in what would one expect if we use the current system going forward under normal conditions, there wouldn't be such a large gap between the pass rate and the combined rate. I think when we've looked at data from the past, we certainly had a much greater rate of growth in this accountability year than we had in the past.

[06:11:56] the rate of growth is the difference, essentially the difference between the pass rate and the combat. I don't want to belabor this. Just one point. I do think anchoring on the pandemic may not actually be especially helpful if this is, like, because it is introducing noise. I'm just speaking for myself. I think this is a problem in terms of the lack of transparency and sort of the lack of responsiveness. I think it's a problem that predates the pandemic. And so, like, my head is more on, like, what kind of system do we need to communicate transparently, drive resources and attention and decision making and deploy those things that it's more than just this is something

[06:12:32] that because of what started in 2020 i think it's a i think it's just a longer term challenge that a lot of states have tackled in different ways and it's now on our plate to tackle when i know we need to move

right okay i i just hope we don't lose track of i mean it has been stated that there's grave concern that once we do identify schools we don't have sufficient resources to support them and i would really like to understand and i think it's important for the board to understand what is true about that statement because ultimately i as i i feel it's

[06:13:08] always easier to describe identify we can do those things very very easily but it is so painful to be on the ground and to be in these situations and not have the resources that you need to change that whether that means having access to teachers who are trained and licensed and able to teach subject matter in the areas that they're licensed to do it. I mean, these things are the things that are demoralizing to underperforming schools. And I sure hope if we're going to change the system to

[06:13:46] identify that we really are not going to do that without making sure there are resources to move the needle because that is going to further really make it hard to have the kind of impacts that we want and we just can't get better at identifying and not find a way to close these gaps because they are talked about quite often i think no child left behind for all of the pain it created

[06:14:23] it was the very first opportunity we had a chance to see that averages high things across the country and so desegregation became something that has been with us for many many many years and still we're not where we need to be so i think that the statements that have been made around what is going to be the resource answer it would be a shame to to drastically change things and not fix that problem i appreciate that comment a lot and let me just ask i mean

[06:14:59] you know we have as a board although not with the necessarily the current composition fully uh talked about the importance of teacher experience and the educational outcomes right teachers building leadership we've talked about that are we willing to transparently measure uh things like the number of first year teachers teachers teaching outside their endorsed area in an individual school and having that be part of the system so that uh again providing an incentive to the districts or to the divisions to uh fairly allocate the experienced teachers around their

[06:15:37] uh division i know that gets a lot of pushback from people right i mean we've heard you know people don't want teachers assigned you know the board's prescribed soqs try to do it with the carrot approach you know more money if you're willing to do that but i think to tammy's point and this may go a little bit further we can continue to rearrange the chairs but unless we change something we're not going to change outcomes and the something that this board historically has agreed would change outcomes is what teachers were putting in front of what kids experience matters which is not to say first year teachers aren't good teachers but they are

[06:16:13] you know early in their teaching journey and they're not necessarily and i know we'll speak to the averages now not to the individuals they're not going to be as good as the second year teacher or the third year teacher who has gone through some learning curve i mean same thing practicing law when i did that right you i was not as good a lawyer in year one as i hope to have been in year two year three etc as you gain the experience classroom management skills etc so let me be clear i have no objection to making changes to the system but i don't want to make changes just to make changes when there's a lot of data out there that indicates you know the

[06:16:49] problems in the system i also wonder and again going back to systemic incentives i am not aware and i'm probably just wrong about this that we have the ability to allocate resources to particular schools uh when i was local elected we had ability to allocate resources to the division not to the schools i

don't know that the state allocates to schools specifically as much as they do to the division and relies on the division to allocate resources i think that's still correct since president this is like it's the everything everywhere all at once problem we cannot solve every problem we're not the budget we don't sit on the budget committee this isn't this is a problem

[06:17:26] we can solve allocation of teachers we can solve through accreditation first problem we can solve is that isn't our purview is transparent information again there's decisions that flow from that we keep i mean i don't think i don't think there's so much disagreement here on some of the resource problems and so forth but we will we will be here and our successors will be here for decades if we continue just to talk about what might you know what conditions are necessary to make a change like this i would argue we have it backwards if you want people to get serious about improving schools you can't keep telling them that 89 of the schools are great in the wake of this pandemic that we just had it doesn't make sense on its face andy what i suggest it doesn't require a

[06:18:05] single additional dollar all it requires is the transparency of telling parents where the experienced teachers are being allocated and if you go back and look at the commonwealth's data you will find invariably among all the jurisdictions with more than one school newer teachers are assigned to schools with a higher percentage of lower socioeconomic kids you won't get an argument out of me on that that is point one so i guess the question was are we will as a board willing to consider a system that incorporates not only performance data but also existing resource allocation data when we know that that resource meaning

[06:18:41] teacher experience has a direct correlation to the end product well it's answering for myself i think we want to be very careful that we think about an accountability system what do you want to hold schools accountable for in a coercive way what do we want to continue to report we've talked about the profiles and i think where and this is one of the lessons of no child left behind where you start to conflate those things you start to get into trouble and so we need to figure out what are the things that are specific accountability things what are the things that are reporting things you know if you're asking like on more reporting or less i think those of you know me like i'm for more i'm a transparency person are you in faith i mean andy i want to just understand

[06:19:18] are you in favor of the question around making transparent the teachers that are teaching in school so that parents can actually understand is my child coming to school every day and being exposed to a substitute because yeah absolutely nobody wants to dr man i actually think parents should have more say in who their kids teachers are so it's not just the fluent teacher the fluid parents with social capital who are able to navigate our schools only because i heard a little bit of a hedge around the concern over we have to be careful about what we're holding schools accountable yeah because if we hold them accountable for everything and look i mean let's

[06:19:57] be honest here if we if we can put in place a whole bunch of stuff we care about and then people are going to sit here and say oh you guys are just setting up schools to fail look at all these ways for them to fail this isn't my first rodeo we need to figure out what are the things that we want to really focus on from an accountability perspective what are the other things we think parents do have a right to know and i think that's a fruitful and really important conversation but this you know we have to be careful that we don't design a system that's impossible for schools nor do we want to have a system that it's too easy to look like you're demonstrating progress we're not presenting an accurate picture and i have confidence in

this board that we that we can get there i think these are decisions that reasonable people can figure out how to how

[06:20:35] to navigate their way through i guess we're going to move on yeah i just would like to make um just we're already on like slide three we're doing i know it i'm looking at about 45 minutes i was counting the cover mr hansen growth mindset please i uh do also just want to make um one comment about the uh supports that schools are given from the office of school quality when we're looking at the accreditation side of the house the support is based on the performance level assigned to the

[06:21:11] indicator so it's not based on whether a school is accredited or accredited with conditions that is um so if for instance a school got that level um one in math um that wouldn't require support from office of school quality if they got a level three or a level two that that would provide them support that is different from on the federal side of the office of school equality those schools do get identified based on our federal indicators and those schools um do apply

[06:21:50] and do get federal funds um based on you know um the support that they need so i just wanted to be clear on what happens on the accreditation side when we're when we're looking at the indicators It's not assigned based on a school's accreditation status, it is assigned based on the performance on the individual indicators.

[06:22:13] That helps me just, this is not a question for today, but going forward, then in terms of the impact of our accountability accreditation system on the Office of School Quality and its ability to fulfill its mandate, I'd love to see the data on how many schools were they required to be were they providing support to pre-pandemic and then post-pandemic and then when we come back next month for whatever changes are being proposed in phase one

[06:22:46] can we get your estimate of how many schools osq will be engaging with if based on current data how many schools will they be being and you've done that for us before you've told us if we were to run the new system on the current data how many schools would be accredited with conditions so we'd love to see that but also how many osq is dealing with pre-pandemic now and post because that's the you know are we getting the resources to that office the um the other just piece to that

[06:23:20] too is as we move along to phase two and then we have the one uh system that would be used for accountability for the federal and the state that would kind of also streamline their support in terms of who would be. Quick question, maybe along those lines. Does your office or the department have a breakdown of the S for COVID funds that are still unspent for this year and next year?

[06:23:51] And I still don't think I even know what the plan is for how they're going to be spent. And I think be really helpful for us to i agree with andy on you know the pre and post we need a system that's going to last you know for the decades but while we're kind of in the middle of the learning loss and the covet loss i as a board member don't know what the spending plan is for uh the covet dollars and how they're being since they really should be targeted at the learning loss i just would like to

[06:24:27] reporting on that we will get that information for you mr hanson and share it with the board yeah we we do have that information it's just a matter of collecting it and sharing and just how it's going to be i think we got another 18 to 36 months or what left on the tail of this but how it's going to be deployed and while we're giving you guys questions to come back to us on i'd be interested for miss holton's question can we also and and i suspect the four of you probably know this in your head so just get it done on paper

what are best in class states for interventions either division level interventions or school level intervention in terms of supporting

[06:25:03] that we're obviously going to get a lot of firsthand expertise on what tennessee did there but there's other states and so particularly states with our constitutional arrangement with regard to the school divisions like what are best practices who's best in breed that kind of thing sure like so in terms of to contextualize miss holton's numbers like what is what is it reasonable to expect based on the people who have the most success mr president i do think you know we're going to get into parts of the presentation that will talk about alternate types of indicators and things which i think will start to probably advance some of the conversation so i think

[06:25:36] there's some some good meat and potatoes to come in the slide deck i just uh as rather am i don't doubt that there are 132 school divisions there are some who don't you know report properly or do things i i can only speak to the part of the state that i'm familiar with which is the smaller divisions and in those divisions um we don't teach percentages we teach children and we teach every individual child and then we aggregate that data up to get our percentages and so we absolutely know where they are and what they're doing and you don't have to be level three to be getting support

[06:26:12] if you're a level two on the bubble you know and even even moderate sides at divisions we use the colors and the charts and the levels so so that each school has what they're doing and there's there's walkthroughs. I just want to put a little bit of comfort out there that our schools are working very, very hard, and they know where their children are. There are things that we can prove, but the other thing, before those schools are working very hard, to bifurcate the system, for them to know my accreditation is not going to be at risk while we are working hard on children achieving is going to be a good thing. That's going to be a very good thing, which I think

[06:26:50] it's at the point that by separating them out that that that is that is going to be good but um uh we are we are we are teaching every individual child and we are aggregating that data up and and for most divisions the state system is the one that matters because they don't have their own locally created one um i'm down dot you're referring to a big division that serves lots of children but of the 132 divisions out there um good work is being done and better clarity and the challenge going to be we need to clarify have clarity of a complex system public education is a complex system and i think what you were pointing out earlier we have to choose carefully what indicators

[06:27:29] we use which ones we we wait and count and which ones we just report because not everything is equally important so we really need to have the ones that have the highest effect size i think that's right and i'll just add like one of the problems of the system i would suggest is it doesn't meaningfully differentiate and you have to be very careful if we put tons of indicators in and only a couple of them actually vary you create a system that appears to have lots of indicators actually hinges on one or two things and that's a mistake we've seen some other places make so we also want to make sure we're actually meaningfully differentiating in a way that that is that is

[06:28:05] useful for all stakeholders your task now is to do the next 10 slides in about two and a half minutes just to leave them no opportunity to comment no go ahead thank you all right um to get us back on track this um again is just part of the background information uh in regards to governor youngkin's accountability goal of course his goal is to create the best in class accountability system that has high expectations for all students and provides stakeholders a clear picture how every

[06:28:45] school is serving its students and placing a an emphasis on the proficiency of students but also recognizing growth and the purpose for this would be so that schools would get timely and active actively productive supports from the department in the areas in which they need support so again um making that very specific to to where their performance um may indicate that

[06:29:19] they they need help this um next slide has the the overall guiding principles um the north star of course is high expectations for every student making sure that the system provides transparent and actionable information and again that proficiency and growth are both vital measures to an accountability system but it must prioritize getting every student proficiency and using this accountability system again to identify the areas where schools need supports and having those

[06:29:57] necessary uh supports provided by the department um and and building trust between schools parents and students so that the parents and the community know the performance of the school on the various indicators and one of the also guiding principles is really based on the governor's principles and yours that you have stated that stakeholder input is critical to the process and we will have that

[06:30:33] built into the entire timeline as we reform this accountability system there are also some other key objectives related to the accountability system that are occurring simultaneously setting new cut scores for reading and math the house bill 585 work group on the future of assessments and of course they are also working on some information portals and systems and tools so that parents and teachers have timely information to data they have recently been

[06:31:12] training school divisions on vivos which is as a way in which student growth is is measured based on historical data there's the bridging the gap program that is working uh with certain school divisions on personalized learning plans for students and then the last key objective is to provide the strategic supports to make sure schools can make meaningful improvements all right so i

[06:31:47] wanted to just review this again just so we're all on the same page when we're talking about what the the meat of the presentation is today the blue circles are the current structure of our accountability model we have the standards of quality we have an accreditation system that we use for our state purposes that accreditation system does include compliance measures and it does include student outcome measures virginia is unique that we do have

[06:32:26] a an accountability system based on student measures that is called accreditation most states do not have that terminology for their accountability system uh you'll notice there is also a a separate accountability system for our federal accountability and that has is based just on student outcomes the set of student outcomes that is in the essa accountability model is different than the student outcomes that are currently in our state accreditation system

[06:33:05] so there's two different sets of indicators for each of those systems and then of course we have the school quality profiles which is the reporting mechanism that we report out on school performance the overall intent of the the reformation is to have two distinct systems one where accreditation is based solely on compliance measures so when we're talking about compliance measures we're talking about staffing leadership requirements requirements on course offerings facilities

[06:33:41] safeties those those types of compliance measures that make sure that the the schools have all of the essential processes or structures and resources in place to operate efficiently and safely the other green circle on the bottom of that graphic is the accountability model which we will have just one

accountability model based on one set of indicators that will be used for both state and federal accountability that new accountability system because it will be used for federal

[06:34:19] accountability will have to satisfy the essa requirements and then of course we would still have that school quality profiles that's uh reporting out on school performance one comment i brought up the last time was just the hope that because the dotted line is going to from standards of quality to the accreditation system and referencing it as compliance that maybe there was a way to think about that as best practices or something that doesn't appear compliance can

[06:34:54] almost invite you know a narrative of it being sort of basics or whereas the standards of quality as we have tried to embody them from the board's perspective really speak to the things that we think make sense and are important for schools to be attending to so i just thought compliance and standards of quality seem to diminish somewhat the importance of what it represents so maybe maybe something that's best practices or I don't know but I just wanted to call that forward again

[06:35:32] because I remember being struck by that at our last work session thank you for that feedback this next slide shows the different phases of the reformation process for the accountability system the blue circle on the left is our current system that we have in place now that will be used in fall of 2023 to give accreditation ratings for this school year, 22-23, and again, this

[06:36:11] particular, in this fall, we will have accreditation ratings, and then we will also have federal accountability with the system that we have now. Phase one would be implemented the following fall, in fall of 2024 and that would be based on the 23-24 school year data phase one should be considered a transitional stage in which we will try to provide greater differentiation between

[06:36:44] schools prioritize proficiency and growth and provide more transparency and uh more clearly identify where schools need support in what areas that would lead us to that circle on the right which is phase two which would be the fully bifurcated system that currently is scheduled to be implemented in fall of 2025 based on 24 25 school year data and that is where we would have the accreditation as compliance measure and then we would have the one accountability model that

[06:37:20] would be used for both state and federal purposes what we are going to be talking about today is that phase the phase one changes so before we get into the recommended phase one changes there are just a couple things i want to make sure that the board is aware of first of all there is going to be no voting on any of the recommendations today today isn't uh that's not the purpose of today's

[06:37:54] session your discussion on the recommended changes is going to provide us input as we create the final recommendations that we will bring to you at the april business meeting for first review so today is a discussion where we're gathering your input again you're not voting on these particular recommendations today at the april business meeting we will have data that's going to help you inform the your decision about the particular changes that we would be recommending

[06:38:33] and bringing to you at that time the other thing that i want to the other thing that i want to emphasize is that this phase one is a transitional stage and it will provide progress towards the governor's goal but it is not going to address all of the concerns perhaps that board members have

[06:39:07] with this with the certain with the current model so the changes that we are recommending today focus on promoting proficiency and growth and being transparent about student performance they are intended to more closely align the assigned performance level to its intended description and its

intended interpretation so that again would be increasing the transparency about the school's performance on an indicator and then of course increasing expectations for

[06:39:43] student performance there are some limitations to phase one and it really is not the phase where we will be changing or fixing all board concerns regarding the current model because this is just really the first step to transform the accountability model there is not existing board authority to make extensive changes to the indicators that we are likely going to be

[06:40:17] discussing and updating when the complete reformation is complete. So an example of that is you've had conversations previously on the graduation measure. That's not something that can be changed, and we'll talk about that a little bit later, but that's not something that's going to be totally fixed so to speak in phase one but that would be something we would look at for phase two all right so phase one is based on the authority that the board has to make

[06:40:52] changes and on the screen are are the different part of the regulations that outline the changes the board has the authority to make so um the board does have the ability to adjust benchmarks so these are the performance benchmarks that delineate what performance level an indicator receives the board may also incorporate additional indicators of school quality used for accreditation and if that board does incorporate additional indicators

[06:41:31] they also need to establish performance benchmarks that will be used to assign the performance levels and then that the very last um set of regs at the bottom is the board has the authority to adopt special provisions related to the use and the measurement of a school quality indicator and the board can also alter the inclusions and exclusions from performance level calculations

[06:42:01] so there is quite a bit of flexibility given to the board in the current regulations just as a very quick review this is our current accreditation model you can see on the left hand side of the screen is the current indicators. The first six indicators are indicators for all of the schools and then for schools that have a grade 12 indicator 7, 8, 9 which is the graduation and completion index, the dropout rate, and the college career and civic

[06:42:39] readiness index. Those are also included for those schools that have a grade 12. the indicators are all assigned a performance level level one which is we code green should be indicating that a school is at or above standard level two which is color-coded yellow indicates that the school's performance on an indicator is near the standard and level three which is color-coded red indicates that the performance level is below standard the

[06:43:18] accreditation status that a school is given is based on the performance levels and if all of the indicators have a level one or a level two a school is accredited if at least one of the indicators is a level three the school is accredited with condition so it doesn't really matter whether school has one level three or four level threes the accreditation status assigned to those two schools for example would be accredited with conditions i would like to explain a little

[06:43:56] bit in detail the how the performance level is based and how we use benchmarks to determine the level because this is is an essential concept for some of the changes that we are recommending so i do want to talk about the performance benchmarks and they are delineated in in the regulations you see on the screen but the performance benchmarks there's there's two different pieces to the performance benchmarks there are actual performance benchmarks and there

[06:44:33] are benchmarks that indicate improvement over time so the actual performance benchmarks and i am going to actually have this up while i am speaking on what these are so you have a visual the actual performance benchmarks on this visual here are highlighted in green and that's when the school's current or cumulative three-year rate on an indicator meets a certain value so this is an

[06:45:09] example for english and so the performance benchmark for english is 75 so if a school had a current year rate of 75 or a three-year cumulative rate of 75 it would earn a level one you can see here on the screen as well the performance benchmarks for a level two and a level three those are highlighted as well there's also improvement benchmarks and those are

[06:45:46] highlighted in yellow and improvement benchmarks are used when we are assigning a level based on really two pieces and i'm going to kind of go to this slide to show you the the two pieces are in red on this particular screen in order to use improvement to earn a performance level there's there's two components so you have um for instance we're going to look at this particular slide and

[06:46:21] we're looking at level two so in order for a school to use a level two there is the actual performance benchmarks at the top that shows the range that a school would have to be in but then there's also the ability for a school to earn a level two by having a current year rate that's greater than or equal to 50 percent and less than or equal to 65 percent so that is one component of being able to earn a level two the other component that goes along with that

[06:46:59] is if the school is within that range and they also decrease the failure rate by at least 10 from the previous year if those two pieces are met then that school will earn a performance level of a level two so again if you were to look at the actual performance rate for that level two it's 65 to 75 percent but the performance level if you're trying to use improvement is lower it's

[06:47:35] 50 to 65 percent loss you have to show that decrease in the failure rate the other thing i want to point out here is um there's a 50 that is highlighted in blue and that is what a lot of times is referred to as the floor that is the lowest performance uh that's the lowest percentage that a school can earn uh to to use improvement to get into a level two so are there any questions

[06:48:10] on how these performance benchmarks are set up all right the reason all of that was important is because in the the following tables when we look at the recommended changes you will see the term adjust the improvement benchmarks and i am going to just go back one more time to this slide and when we're talking about the improvement benchmarks we're talking about the ranges that are

[06:48:45] in the yellow we are not talking about the ranges that are in the green i just want to be very clear on that so as we are talking about adjusting the improvement benchmarks there are different ways that this can be done so for example to earn a level one in english a school can earn a rate that's greater than 65 percent and less than 75 percent and show that sufficient improvement by

[06:49:18] reducing the failure rate from the previous year by 10 percent so the adjustment to that improvement benchmark could be and i've got here for example because this is just an example we could change that improvement benchmark to say greater than 75 or 70 percent and less than 75 percent so we

[06:49:44] would be changing the uh that bottom uh end of the range from 65 to 75 to 70 another way of in adjusting the benchmarks is by increasing the floor so for example um to earn a level two in English, a school can earn a rate that's greater than or equal to 50 percent and less than or equal

[06:50:14] to 65 percent. We could reduce that floor or, I'm sorry, change that floor to 55 percent or 60 percent, for example. So instead of having that be from 50 to 65 percent, perhaps it could be 55 to 65 percent or 60 to 65 percent and again the numbers that are listed here are for example these are not numbers that we are recommending it's just to illustrate how those ranges could be changed

[06:50:50] and then the last way that a benchmark could be adjusted is by actually adding a floor the there are some accreditation indicators where there is no established floor and gci is one of them so for example a school that has a gci rate less than or equal to 80 percent can earn a level two as long as the school increases the rate from two and a half from the previous year that's their improvement that that's necessary so that benchmark could be

[06:51:26] modified for example to include a floor so that that criteria would be greater than or equal to 70 percent and less than or equal to 80 percent all right so now we are getting into the list of possible changes that can be made to the indicators this chart or this table is set up so that the indicators are on the left possible changes are in the next column the justification

[06:52:04] for the change is in the third column and the regulatory code granting authority is in the right hand column the first indicator which is academic achievement in mathematics that is determined by a combined rate in grades three through eight and a pass rate at the high school and the recommended change to that would be a possible changes adjusting the improvement

[06:52:35] benchmarks underneath that first row is the second row and that is adding a separate indicator that is just the annual pass rate for mathematics so that would be an additional indicator that's added to the current six for the elementary school or nine for the high school we would have to or the board would have to set the level one two and three performance benchmarks that would have to

[06:53:09] be determined this benchmark or i'm sorry this indicator could be added similar to the academic achievement indicator where we report that out for all students it could also be added as similar to the achievement gap indicator where we desegregate that data by the student groups.

[06:53:33] So it would just depend on, you know, your desire for how that would be set up. So again, adding that annual pass rate would provide transparency on the number of students who are proficient.

[06:53:50] Mr. President, I hear you. We've got time constraints, but if I have a question as to recognizing the importance So this material, if I have a question as to this slide, should I do it now or should I save it? Yeah, let's do it. So I know this is so complicated, Amy, and you're doing a great job helping make it simple for us, and I appreciate that.

[06:54:13] But I've been trying to wrap my head around what it would mean to add a pass rate in addition to the combined rate indicator. And if I understand correctly, the way our structure, the way indicators add up into accreditation status is any, if a school slips into level three on any one indicator, then they are accredited with conditions, right?

[06:54:40] So, just am I right? I'm concerned that adding a pass rate indicator could essentially moot the relevance of growth measures. So, for instance, if you added, I'm sorry, back to that last slide.

[06:55:00] if you added an annual pass rate for mathematics now if if the level one two and three performance benchmarks are the same as for the math uh the current math indicator and i've recognized

that's an if but if if they are the same then would not it be the case that it's mathematically impossible for a school to pass the growth of the combined rate unless they also pass the the pass rate so

[06:55:37] if they were the same yes it would so so it all gets down to the details of the performance bank so in other words if unless those performance benchmarks are different if if they're the same then you might as well just wipe out the top indicator because the past you basically you're not paying attention to growth anymore either you pass or you don't and so if we want to continue to focus on reward and encourage growth the growth indicator only matters uh if the pass

[06:56:14] rate indicator doesn't moot it out essentially and the only way to make the pass rate indicator not mooted out would be essentially to set those improvement benchmarks lower than the benchmarks for the math though the combined rate okay thank you just to be clear we haven't set the benchmarks for the new indicators so that would need to be established so right don't assume that it would be the same much more right so they would have to be lower right but to have the growth measure the measure that includes growth still have any relevance well your your regulations around the

[06:56:50] establishment of benchmarks say that we will look at data and make a data-informed decision so that that's what we would bring back to you at some point in the future next month yes probably that's the intent please try to say like how disruptive this system and any of these proposed changes are to the current system depends on those choices around the performance level and they can be sort of minimally disruptive or massively disruptive i think that's why you look at the data and you see is there sort of a natural company in the data where it might make sense to

[06:57:30] a set of performance level, it's actually between a level three and a level two and a level one. So I think that's really good to do with Chad and I will be working with the team to think about and present back to y'all. And to your point, too, I think that, like, to me, the way I see this right now is that the academic achievement indicator at the top is really more of a growth measure.

[06:57:50] Because at the end of the day, the combined rate is looking both at that pass rate and then it bumps it up based on all these different ways that you can make growth. So right now the system is really looking more at growth and not very much at pass rates.

[06:58:06] And so this adding a second indicator would sort of be giving you a proficiency pass rate indicator alongside a more gross oriented indicator and giving them more equal weight. But, you know, sending the performance specials is going to be if you all are moving forward with this would be.

[06:58:26] So if I may, thank you, Ms. Hyslop, it's delightful to have you here and we heard earlier that you're going to be engaged with us on it and we're really grateful for your help but i guess my concern is just to not lose the power of growth and given that the way our system is structured and i don't think we can change this as part of phase one but you all can tell us i don't think we can change it without getting into the regulations or the statute that any failure on any one indicator is knocks you out of full accreditation so you're not averaging you know if you have a growth measure and a proficiency measure and then you're

[06:59:04] averaging them in some way that's one thing but that's not what our system does if you fail on any one you fail overall on a on your full accreditation right if I'm right that that can't be adjusted in phase one and I haven't analyzed that myself but that's what I'm hearing then that does you know that how do

you have if you want to give more weight to proficiency I get that but how do you that without knocking out the relevance of growth. Yeah, I think you're 100% correct though that like

[06:59:39] I imagine the recommendation from the team would be you know setting a performance threshold on just a pass rate indicator that would be lower than the combined rate recognizing that you have you know those schools that um you just look at the data the combined rate and you saw like what's the median combined rate in Virginia it's going to be much higher than the median pass rate in virginia and that would be the type of data that we prefer thank you

[07:00:11] all right um i am now on slide 25 and the next indicator is one of our current indicators which is the achievement gap indicator the difference between the achievement gap indicator and the academic achievement indicator in math is the way it's reported out. The academic achievement indicator is reported out for all students. An achievement gap is reported out for

[07:00:48] each of the student groups that you see on the screen. There are decision rules, so each of those student groups gets a performance level assigned. There are some decision rules that kind of fold up into an overall performance level designation the possible changes for this achievement gap indicator for math again could be adjusting the improvement benchmarks but you will also see that one of the recommendations is adding the lowest performing students as a separate group

[07:01:26] in that achievement gap indicator so what our current train of thought is for that is that that lowest performing group of students would be the lowest performing 25 of students at a school so in the fall you'd look back see how the students did on their spring sol test and the lowest 25 percent of those students would be in that lowest performing student group and that way

[07:01:59] every single school has a lowest performing student group there would um regardless really of what the the overall like mean performance level was for the uh school it just every school would have a lowest 25 so we would that recommendation would be adding that to achievement gap so i don't

[07:02:26] know if we want to comment on that now or wait or these next indicators are the parallel indicators to math and these are the english indicators i do want to point out that the academic achievement indicator for english does include reading and writing scores we do administer a grade 8 writing test and some of the high schools administer the eoc writing test there are other options

[07:03:04] besides administering that writing test but that is one of the set of test scores that is is in that academic achievement english rate you will see that for grades three through eight again it's a combined rate and there is also a combined rate at the high school the combined rate for english is a little bit different than it is for math and that the combined rate has an additional component and that are is l students who failed the test and didn't demonstrate growth but they

[07:03:41] do demonstrate growth on english language proficiency so that is just an added component to the combined rates for english so again a possible change for that indicator is adjusting the improvement benchmarks and then you can see on that second row is adding an annual pass rate for reading and again those level one two and three benchmarks would have to be determined and then when you look at the achievement gap again it parallels the changes that are being recommended

[07:04:20] for mathematics we could adjust the improvement benchmarks and also we're recommending adding that lowest performing student group to the achievement gap the slide 29 talks about three other

indicators the academic achievement and science is already it's an annual pass rate so a possible change for that would be to adjust the improvement benchmarks and then you will see

[07:04:59] two other indicators that are on the second and the third row the second one is chronic absenteeism and the possible change for that is suspending the use of the chronic absenteeism as an indicator though still reporting out the rate and the performance level i do want to mention that there is a board item that you will be seeing tomorrow with a proposal to suspend the chronic absenteeism indicator for this current school year that is different than what you're seeing here

[07:05:37] this is suspending the use of the chronic absenteeism indicator uh during phase one just so you're aware you'll see that tomorrow but for the current school year and then for the college and career and civic readiness indicator we are not recommending any changes this is the first year that that's being implemented you'll also notice in that justification section there are a couple notes regarding chronic absenteeism and the cccri those two indicators i am sure will be re-evaluated and there will be a

[07:06:14] lot of discussion around them during phase two in terms of their inclusion in the model and whether we wanted to make any changes or if we wanted to make any changes to them the next slide just ask a question on the chronic absenteeism and I know it's probably more for tomorrow but just for the suggestion of not including it this year it said we still will be collecting the data it's just not

[07:06:51] going to be utilized as an indicator for impact I guess yes yes sir all right this next slide has information on the graduation measures and the reason it's in here is I know that in past meetings there has been discussion about the graduation measures and and what is included in our accountability model so i just wanted to delineate the three graduation measures that are used in

[07:07:27] virginia the first one is the virginia on-time graduation rate and this is the official graduation rate that was adopted by the board it is a four-year rate and includes students with standard diplomas advanced diplomas ib or applied studies diplomas this looks at students who entered high school four years prior and determines the percent of students that that graduated within four years there is flexibility with this virginia on-time graduation rate for students

[07:08:05] with disabilities or for english learners who have more time to graduate based on their ieps or their uh their lep plans to to graduate with with additional years the federal graduation indicator is another indicator that's used in our federal accountability system this is also a four-year rate. And this rate, though, only includes students with a standard advanced or

[07:08:37] ILEE diploma. It doesn't include students who have an applied studies diploma. This, again, also consists of students who started high school four years prior. But for the FGI, there's no flexibility given for students with disabilities or for English learners. The measure is what is the outcome four years after they enter high school. And then the last measure that we report out on is the graduation and completion index, and that is used for accreditation. And this is

[07:09:13] an index that provides information on a number of different outcomes, and those outcomes are weighted. And this particular index includes students who earn the standard advanced IB or applied studies diploma it also includes students who earn a ged or a certificate of completion and it also gives some weight to students who do not earn a diploma in their intended graduation

[07:09:46] year but they remain enrolled and return to try to earn their diploma this rate also gives flexibilities for students with disabilities and english learners to have additional time to graduate

according to their individualized plans so this is the current calculation of the graduation and completion index down the left hand side you will see the various outcomes and

[07:10:19] then in the third column you will see the weighted values for those outcomes and you can see the highest weighted value is a diploma so for every student who earns a diploma 100 points are assigned for those students and then you can see the weighted values in the chart for the other outcomes geds are worth 75 points certificate of completion are worth 25 those students who remain enrolled in order to try to earn their diploma are worth 70 points and then you will also notice that

[07:10:56] dropouts are included in this index but they are assigned zero points so in the current regulations the gci is specified as an indicator in our current system the outcomes that are in this table are also listed in the regulations what is not listed in the regulations are the point values that are assigned for each of those outcomes so should the board want to investigate changing the

[07:11:30] the number of points per outcome that is something that we could do this particular slide here talks about the gci what we are recommending is just adjusting the improvement benchmarks for this particular index and we are also recommending that the dropout rate be suspended as an indicator because the dropouts are already incorporated into that gci as you saw on the previous screen

[07:12:07] though we still would report that rate and the performance level but we would suggest suspending the use of that dropout rate as an indicator and then this last slide is just something the department can take to somewhat increase the transparency on the school quality profiles so on the current school quality profiles when you go on that accreditation tab there's a there's a gray box at the top of that accreditation tab and it gives the accreditation status and

[07:12:45] what the accreditation status was the previous year what we can do on in that gray box is to identify the status of the school but then also identify whether there were any level three indicators and how many of those indicators were a level three so in that top example there is a school that was accredited with conditions the reason that was accredited with conditions was because four out of the nine indicators were a level three and then it shows the accreditation

[07:13:23] status from the previous year that bottom um example shows a school that is accredited but you'll notice on that second line it does say that the school has one indicator that is a level three and the reason that school has the status of accredited but still has a level three is because it used its triennial accreditation option or waiver that is available so again even though

[07:13:57] the school is accredited providing transparency on where the school may be in or is in need of support i do want to say that there are descriptions of key terms including triennial accreditation that are on the sqp this is just a very small snippet just to kind of emphasize putting that number of level three indicators underneath the status and for our newer board members um triennial accreditation is actually in the law and it says that if a school has been

[07:14:36] accredited for the three previous years it is automatically accredited for three more uh regardless of the performance on the benchmark the indicators and the benchmarks this year that accounted for what about eight percent of the continuing accreditations i i know we said the numbers were the same but i and i did a quick look at how many how many how many how many how many schools would not have been accredited but for the three-year accreditation in other words did the system fail or did what was the masking the three-year accreditation we can't

[07:15:12] remember right now but yeah i think it was between 130 and 150 there's some number in there out of 1800 yeah my recollection was about eight percent was the gap you know those schools that were accredited by the three year that would not have been in a single year yeah i can't remember the exact number oh i i hope for me this is a final question but um uh i appreciate the slide one of the principles is that the department wants to gather wide input uh and that you're going to use

[07:15:46] the hb 585 task force somewhat for that input so i i would just love a a description of well specifically with respects to hb 585 uh we were told last month that they would be meeting in march and so i'm curious has the have the members been designated and can we be can that list be shared with us and has a has it met already and are they going to weigh in on these have a chance at helping you shape these recommendations before they come to us for first review and beyond.

[07:16:19] So it's a compound question. That's how I get by with saying one final question. And beyond the HB 585 task force, what other stakeholder groups do you anticipate gathering input on this from before it comes to us for first review?

[07:16:38] So, Amy, I will try to help you with that one. Okay, go ahead. And Kim will help as well. so we are um going to seek input from stakeholders and actually ann and chad will be helping us with that activity um we did have a webinar with superintendents yesterday to provide an overview of the presentation you just saw um in terms of houseville 585 kim would you like to address yeah absolutely so thank you for the question miss holton um the um you know obviously the 585 group is focused on assessments it is not focused on accountability so the group is assembled to

[07:17:18] examine our current summative assessment system and make recommendations to the general assembly about how to move forward in creating a more effective assessment system overall i think what what amy's slide conveys is that that work of the 585 committee will align with what this board is doing right so a strong and transparent accountability system is based on a strong summative assessment system and so the work certainly um is interrelated but i don't see the 585 committee specifically weighing in on the recommendations that you see in this report this

[07:17:54] is under the board's purview i'm sure accountability will come up because as i mentioned it's related to assessments and we want the board and will encourage that committee to look at the whole system comprehensively because it is all connected and it is related and it is important to having a strong accountability system but the the purposes of the the purpose of the 585 group is different than than than coming up with a phase one and in phase two um set of recommendations for this board to consider then if i may by follow up then uh are so talking with last that's hugely

[07:18:34] wonderful um the other organizations in the uh the public education coalition in virginia pta vea the principals association vascd who else am i leaving out but all of those organizations i think would be very interested in helping uh formulate these proposals as they come forward and i'm curious is how what is your input process before you come to us for first review does it include those groups so i we we do not have a detailed list of groups that um that we have

[07:19:13] already identifying i think that's an on it's an ongoing process and we certainly plan on casting a very broad net and getting getting input from stakeholders from as many stakeholders as as possible and if if any board member has specific groups that they think should be included i think we would welcome that we would welcome that that input um what there is that there is an existing group of the public education coalition then you you know you could pull them all together in one big meeting if you wanted

but and that this is this stuff matters to all of them all of those stakeholders from the parents groups the school board of the sba that one i left out school board

[07:19:48] association etc um it would be i think incredibly important to get their input as early on in this process and certainly to me that would be the thing you would want to do before you actually present your uh recommendations to us that is our plan great yeah and uh both i think and honestly i think stakeholder input will be ongoing up to first review but also up to final review for the board right so the for the full um for the full two two plus months that we have to finalize the

[07:20:20] phase one recommendations president i'd like to really thank staff for the thought and time it took to take us deep into the weeds because i think we had to go deep and deep into the weeds it's necessary important i'd like to kind of zoom us back out for just a moment as we get ready to transition to other topics again i appreciate the thought and brainstorming it's gone into what could be in phase one my concern is that some of these brainstorms actually are complex changes to an already complex system and and adding complexity as our ultimate goal was clarity i just i just

[07:20:58] want to be cautious but again i think we had to go in the weeds and see some examples to maybe discover that i also don't want you know the staff and the board and also our divisions and our schools working really hard on complexities for phase one when we really have in mind what we'd like to see in phase in phase two so maybe maybe so i would i would just want to make sure that every step we take in phase one is actually toward phase two. And this gets me to the zoom out point. So perhaps in addition to looking at what we can do right now, we really need to sketch out in broad terms what we ultimately want. If we can sketch out in broad terms what we ultimately

[07:21:34] want, then we can make sure the little steps we make in phase one are actually toward that goal. And we don't invest time and energy in things that maybe don't get us toward what we want. That also helps us begin very proactively having conversations about the ultimate goal and and how to get to those.

[07:21:50] And I agree that the 585 work group is going to be very important because if we're going to have a better accountability system, we have got to modernize our assessments. So it's a lot of moving pieces, but sometimes I guess I like to backpack. I've got to know the destination so that I can really look at the map and figure out the best trail to get there.

[07:22:12] And so I think we got to zoom out to the destination. Wow, they teach you all those metaphors in superintendent school. that's good i like that voice guys i like that a lot mr president i just have a quick question that's not nearly as sagacious as my colleague from blacksburg um we had a triennial accreditation bill to change that and it did not get through in this session is that correct am i correct and that was an apartment bill and it just didn't okay when you say try and we had one that would have reduced it from three to one we had a bill i think that's it thank you guys so much

[07:22:51] uh we appreciate the trip through the weeds and we i think we're going to take a uh 10 minute

[07:22:57] break with the board regroup and we'll see you guys at 325 thanks for the afternoon so of course

[07:33:07] i'm delighted because i care so much about this next issue that's going to be here to welcome you miss conway and force delegate corner and um karen little actually dr salari yes i'm sorry I'm looking here at my agenda, which doesn't have that information updated. Apologies. Welcome.

[07:33:27] We're delighted to have you. And Evan, you're going to talk to us about the Literacy Act. Virginia Literacy Act. Absolutely. And just in real time, we're doing a couple of shifts here to make sure that we can get everybody to speak. But I'm Jenna Conway. I am our Deputy Superintendent of Early Childhood Care and Education and serving as point for the department on the implementation of the Virginia Literacy Act. What I'd like to do first before I go into an overview of the law, where we are, accomplishments since we've last come together, and we turn into a deep dive on

[07:34:04] our instructional review process, is to see if Delegate Coyner would like to say a couple of words. Delegate Coyner is one of the co-authors, co-patrons, excuse me, of the law. Well, good afternoon, everyone. Thank you for allowing us to come and present. I'm really just going to share some progress on the expansion of the literacy act because i know that these two amazing women are going to walk you through all the work that they've been doing on implementation of the k3 portion of the literacy act so we did have success this year legislatively senator lucas and i were

[07:34:39] were the senate and house patrons of the expansion of the literacy act we were successful in working with um dr solari at uva and crafting the expansion to that to ensure that there was consistency and our our children who i lovingly refer to as our covet babies who experience their the youngest grades in our schools um are the furthest behind in learning gaps and our our literacy act from the first year does nothing to help any of those children because they will age out of the grades So there is some urgency around the four through eight expansion.

[07:35:17] We are really, really lucky that we have Dr. Solari and the Virginia Literacy Partnership that VOE has with UVA because their resources are lined up and ready to move very, very quickly. I'm just hoping that we end up with a budget sooner than later so that we can continue developing the things that we don't have today in Virginia.

[07:35:36] So I just want to highlight a few of the key things. If you are a 3rd through 8th grader in Virginia today and you fail your reading SOL, we do not currently have a screener in place that tells your teacher why you can't comprehend. So part of the Expansion Act is allowing Dr. Solari to develop that screener that will continue the K-3 that we already have through 4 through 8 that will be able to immediately be administered upon not passing of that SOL to immediately start appropriate interventions and supports for every child who does not pass that SOL. So that's really key. It also expands our professional development

[07:36:13] to our reading teachers through those upper years. It ensures that we have expansion of additional literacy coaches throughout the state. So some really great work in the bill that we passed this year and really excited about adding reading specialists into our middle schools as well.

[07:36:30] I will say I'm very involved. I'm blessed to be able to serve on the task force that meets regularly on the the current literacy act one area that i i would say we could two areas i would say we could use some help in one they have worked very hard as you'll hear in the presentation on the review of curriculum so that we can assure every classroom in virginia has scientifically based readings research based curriculum in front of children that teachers are using but it will require if you all are able to hold an extra board meeting in may so that we can more quickly get

[07:37:05] curriculum into our schools. They have worked as fast as they can, but your schedule with your board meetings and when school divisions are really hoping they can get curriculum before another school year, it would be. And I have talked to Mr. Gecker about that, and he said that he would talk with

folks about being able to perhaps do that. And the second thing that UVA is not working on directly and that we really left the department to focus on is the micro-credential and around licensing for the reading specialists i am at a worry point i'll be honest with you over

[07:37:39] that we have met for about a year on this issue with the folks here who are working on that and we just haven't seen the needle move i do think there are some great folks out in the education world who are here in virginia who we could probably pull in to help us move that a little faster uva is able to help with that as well this was the one thing that we were not asking them to carry the load on we know they're able to but i would say um from my perspective of implementation it's the one area that i have some warning signs on and with that i'll turn it back over so that you can hear the progress on the current act excellent thank you delegate coiner um i'm

[07:38:16] going to move with some speed because i do want to make sure that we have time for dr solari to walk through us in detail through the instructional review process um so i'll ask you hold your questions, but know that I can stay later, even after she has to leave. But I always want to start with the why. I think we've got the champion in the room here in terms of delegate coiner and the multiple reasons for existence for the VLA. We've talked about the COVID babies. And again, you all know, as the parent of children who were six, four, and two in March of 2020, we saw historic

[07:38:55] setbacks we also know from the data i've presented to you all before that this predated the um the pandemic and the sort of it pre-existed in terms of some of our sol data our pals data our nape data our focus is on as uh the delegate described how do we put the best possible resources at the fingertips of teachers and families and all those who support our k-3 classrooms now with potential uh ages to come to make sure that we're using the best of science across all of our virginia classrooms we know this is particularly important i know as we've talked with with you miss man

[07:39:34] about or dr man rather about the the kids that tend to not have the opportunity to come to third grade right and just disproportionately our students who are black latino english language learners children with special needs and really trying to reverse that trend and make sure every child every student in the commonwealth has the opportunity to read by third grade because that tracks with really future academic success um as well as life success i currently have a fourth grader every aspect of his day is reading um and really making sure that all of our kids have that opportunity to be successful 4 8 4 12 post career hinges on getting them on level by third grade

[07:40:10] um delegate coiners spoke a little bit about the law just an important piece to echo here is there are multiple pieces because when these folks looked across the country at what it would take to move the needle in literacy you cannot approach this in a piecemeal fashion you have to think about higher red you have to think about the curriculum that are being used you need to think about the current professional development the ongoing professional development for all the current teachers in the system and you certainly have to think about parents our children's first and most important educators and so our efforts are trying to figure out how we infuse science-based reading research and evidence-based literacy instruction into all aspects of the classroom

[07:40:49] of the for and supporting both educators and families to do this effectively these are just the descriptions of the law again i've walked through this before we'll come back to this if there are questions here but just to to demonstrate again how comprehensive it is and trying to address every aspect of the system i wanted just to to to further elaborate on uh what delegate Coiner noted just so you see the context

before we go deeper in the weeds with Dr. Solari on what's currently happening with the instructional materials review but that's our our highlight

[07:41:22] for today and what we will bring to you all as early as May and in June is we'll bring to you some reviewed a list of materials that we think fully reflect the evidence basis the science-based reading research and that will need your approval so in turn we can share them with with school divisions. But designing this process, which you'll hear from my colleague in a second, has been incredibly intensive, rigorous, and involved Virginia educators at every step in the way. And we feel really proud about what we're presenting to you today. No decisions today, but because it's such a lengthy process, we wanted to walk you through very similar to what my colleagues

[07:41:59] did earlier in preparation for decisions in the future. We've launched the advisory work group, as Delegate Coyner noted, with 33 members from across the state. Every superintendent region is represented broad stakeholders, and we meet quarterly with them to share where we are, to have them reflect on materials. So, for example, before we go statewide with our training model for reading specialists, we took it to them first, shared it with them, and then broke into small groups and got their feedback as Virginia educators and Virginia stakeholders on what they liked, what they didn't, what they want to change. We have, in partnership with Virginia Literacy Partnership,

[07:42:35] hired six literacy coaches who will again over the course of the next few years support the various levels of the system. We are not proposing one and done professional development. We know that is not how adult learning works. And so building infrastructure to support ongoing professional development for our reading specialists, our teachers and principals is a top priority. So those very same literacy coaches are working with VLP to design the training and think about the adult learning on a longitudinal basis. We've continued to overhaul the literacy screener. I'll talk a moment about that. Soft launch that this year with 17 school

[07:43:09] divisions. We've engaged in national conversations. And again, we've been around the state. I think I've been to every single superintendent's meeting. We've seen all of the groups, VSBA, VAS, VPAC. It's got letters that start with V. We've probably met with them. Really just at the awareness stage right now in terms of really changing hearts and minds about why early literacy matters and how we can all partner together to implement the literacy. High-level timeline, just to highlight what's coming to you, again, provided we've got to settle on a May date, but our goal is to later this spring bring to you the first approved list, the results of round one, which Dr. Solari will talk in more

[07:43:48] detail about, but that's a big step in terms of sharing with the state. Here are the resources that are fully aligned with the science of reading. We will already have begun round two to take in additional materials, potential materials going up to grade eight, as well as supplemental and intervention materials. We'll kick off training this summer. And then over the course of next year, we'll bring any resource that the law requires us to take to the board. So guidance on the student-specific reading plan or on the literacy plan, in addition to bringing review materials to you. So you'll see a lot of us over the course of the next year as we prepare for

[07:44:21] full implementation by 24-25. And this is just another way of thinking about what's ahead. there's two other really important things to note um that are also underway and you'll hear us talk about this and i should note that i serve as the team captain here but work with incredible folks including people in the room our special education our school quality our humanities and our learning our teacher

licensure education and licensure as well as my early childhood colleagues so it really truly takes a village uh in order to prepare all these resources but the two other things in addition to what's spelled out in the VLA is that we are working very closely with Virginia

[07:45:00] Literacy Partnerships at EVA to overhaul the K3 screener in addition to the new developments that the delegates spoke about. And we also presented to you last night the overhaul or the revision of the standards of learning. So kind of multiple things in play, all of which that are set to be implemented in fall of 2024. And so what we're working very hard as a joint team and with the field on how do you prepare, how do you think about what will be different in classrooms in our K-3, K-5 classrooms as of fall of 2024, and how do we support this

[07:45:37] implementation at every level in the system. And so the bullets laid out here today get into that. And then I briefly summarize this. I can also come back to this, but to the questions raised earlier by Ms. Holton, you know that we take engagement very seriously and really think this This is a great law for Virginia students and for Virginia families and want to make sure that we are engaging stakeholders at every step in the process.

[07:46:02] So even though the law didn't require it, it was encouraged that we thought of an advisory body and so we set that up in our meeting quarterly. As you'll hear from Dr. Solari, we wanted to create a Virginia process for reviewing Virginia materials that involves Virginia educators at every step in the way.

[07:46:18] And she'll walk us through that. She separately is helping us lead a task force where we're involving Virginia educators and Virginia experts in the overhaul of the screener, as well as piloting and then soft launching with a diverse set of Virginia school divisions. And as I noted before, continuing to really get out every step in the process, what is happening, what does it mean for you and your constituents, and how do we provide resources to support the implementation, some of which we of course will bring to this board, the tools, the templates, and the guidance. So with that, what I would like to

[07:46:52] do is have Dr. Solari come up. I want to explain before she comes up the role and responsibility of Virginia Literacy Partnership. So historically, the department has worked very closely. What was formerly known as the PALS office, Virginia Literacy Screener. Now it's all coming clear, Dr. Mann. So formerly known as PALS, now known as the Virginia Literacy Screener, arguably a little easier to say PALS than VLS, but we'll go with it. They have extensive, many decades of working very closely with the department, as well as all of our elementary school principals, our K3 teachers,

[07:47:31] so we're able to harness that work. We began the screener overhaul prior to the VLA and then recognized with top-notch expertise at Virginia Literacy Partnerships, as well as these pre-existing relationships knowing that we have worked they have deep relationships with the field we have contracted with virginia literacy partnerships to help us with a couple of things the first is helping us design and implement a rigorous core instructional program review we do textbook review here at the department but we wanted to uh really make sure that we reflected the best of the science

[07:48:07] the best of what we knew about literacy instruction and we needed some outside help to help us design and implement that. And Dr. Solari will describe that. Ultimately, after a few rounds, we will bring that back into the department, but really using them for some additional capacity there. The second thing that they're helping us do is to design the literacy coaches, to the reading specialists, the principals, the teacher, a multi-year combination of in-person and online professional learning for all of our reading

specialists, principals, and teachers. And so we'll bring that to you at a future meeting, but some incredible content that they're helping us develop and making sure that we're not only helping folks understand the science of reading,

[07:48:46] but how they apply it, what it means with the screener. How do you make sense of the new screener results? How do you share that with family? What happens if you're shifting curriculum? All the things that are called for by the law. And then thirdly, they're helping us develop some of the resources required, like the literacy plan, the student-specific reading plan. Again, making sure that there's cohesion across screener, curriculum, assessment, professional learning, that it doesn't feel like 55 different parts coming to each of our K-3, K-5 classrooms. With that, Dr.

[07:49:14] Solari. Thank you, Jenna. So today I'm just going to talk about one part of what we're doing in partnership with the department, and that's the core curriculum review. So we, you know, as a part of the law, it states that divisions will have to choose from a list of approved core curriculum to implement starting in the fall of 2024 for K-3, and then potentially for K-5 when the 4-8 bill goes through. So we started this process May of last year.

[07:49:52] And the way that we started it was I reached out to folks sort of all over the country that I know from other states that have gone through, have had a similar comprehensive literacy law to talk to them about their process, to learn from them, because I think it's really important that we learn from what they did well, what they thought went poorly, to sort of give us some feedback about where to go. We were also very cognizant that we wanted this to be a Virginia-based process, so we were not going to take a national list or a list from another state and say, here we go, this is the Virginia list, because we wanted Virginia educators involved in the process. So when we talk about the list, what What are we actually talking about?

[07:50:28] So our task, we are tasked with providing a list of guidance, a list that is a guidance document to the Department of Education, which will come to this body for approval. And our role in this is to make sure that we are developing and implementing a very rigorous process by which there are experts facilitating the process with the participation of Virginia as our reviewers. And I'll talk a little bit about how we got to that point. So we want to make sure that every child, when they enter a classroom, have high-quality Tier 1 reading instructions,

[07:51:05] that core instruction, and that it's aligned to the definitions in the law, the scientifically-based reading research and also evidence-based literacy instruction. We want to make sure teachers feel supported and well-equipped to meet their students' needs as defined by the law. So when we started this we knew we needed to have some rubrics if we were going to take um core curriculum and we were going to review them we had to have a way in which they were being reviewed so we consulted with folks in colorado arkansas and louisiana around their process as they were a few years ahead of us um we all we um we did a broad rubric development starting last may and june

[07:51:42] we took what we learned from colorado arkansas and louisiana myself one person of my team and two folks from the Department of Education. We met here in a windowless room for a series of days where we sat together and we actually took core curriculum. We said, OK, if we were going to apply this rubric to this curriculum, what does this look like?

[07:52:01] And how do we need to make changes to make sure that this makes sense for Virginia? And the other thing is we wanted to make sure that the rubric fully aligned with the definitions and the law of

evidence-based literacy instruction. So we came up with an initial draft review rubric that we then allowed other folks in Virginia and experts across the country to give us feedback on.

[07:52:26] So we opened it up to K-12, some K-12 educators, as well as our colleagues in higher education. We received their feedback, we revised it, and then we eventually came up with what we are calling our phase one and phase two rubrics. So there's two phases to our review process.

[07:52:43] And in between, we did the simulation essentially, okay, if this is our final rubric, what does this look like? And again, that was in collaboration with the folks at the department. So we put out a call to folks across the Commonwealth just to get review team members.

[07:53:01] And we were overwhelmed with the response. We had 180 applicants in total. We did not think we were gonna get that many. We ultimately ended up with 36 that are on our review teams. We have eight additional reserve team members because things happen.

[07:53:18] And when we invest time, we invest a lot of time in training these folks to make sure that they know how to use the rubric with fidelity. So if someone leaves, it becomes a problem for us. So we have eight reserve team members. We have representation from all the different regions across the Commonwealth.

[07:53:35] And then we wanted to make sure that our teams included teachers, reading specialists, division leads, and administrators. So there are diverse, there are different folks sort of a different lens on literacy instruction we develop webinars to train our reviewers each review team has a facilitator and the facilitator either works for the department of education or works for uva so they work out of the virginia literacy partnerships office that facilitator team meets twice a week to make sure that they are on the same page if there are issues that arise within the week with their review team. They will bring it to the broader team

[07:54:13] to make sure that everyone is on the same page and everyone understands what's going on. So every review team member attended a training for both phase one and phase two of the process to make sure that they can use the rubric with fidelity. We also, when we interviewed them, we had to make sure that they understood what reading science is and what the science of reading is. They had some knowledge of what what evidence-based literature instruction should look like so the two-phase process so phase one is a four-week process and the really the intent of phase one is just to

[07:54:47] ensure it's a much less robust review it's just to ensure that we are eliminating programs that are that are clearly misaligned with scientifically based reading research so if if the program if it was really very clear that it wasn't evidence-based literacy instruction they did not make it through phase one the second phase is uh is longer it's eight weeks and it's when we really dive into each level of the program each grade level that we're reviewing to make sure that they are meeting

[07:55:21] every area of the rubric and also that it aligns to the current sols so the way that we did this is if in phase one um we had a call for both vendors and for divisions so if divisions have their own developed curriculum, they can put it through the same review process and we have been reviewing those at the same time as our commercial vendors, that they are required to go through the same process. If they met criteria, then they got a notice saying you've met criteria and you're moving on to phase two. If they did not meet criteria in phase one, we had a two-week appeal

[07:55:59] window and and the vendors and or the divisions could come back to us and um say you actually missed this piece we want you to re-review and we did that and then we would again respond about whether or not they made it through phase one or phase two phase two again is a much more deep of review of all the different um grid levels and the different content areas that you would want to see in a program that aligns with the definition of the law um and again same thing hear they either meet criteria or if they don't there is an opportunity to appeal so they can appeal the decision and come back to us and we are that same team that reviewed will re-engage

[07:56:37] in the review they can provide us new information or something they think that we may have missed um on the rubric and we will take the time to re-review that so just a overview of our process and our timeline we started in mid-march um or in mid-march the teams are so we didn't start we're here it's mid-march um we are started the review teams have finished the program review and the decisions are being communicated to providers um we do expect that there will be some action in the in the appeal window which is coming right now so the review window start will

[07:57:13] start in early to mid-april uh in mid-april we should have final decisions back to vendors and providers at which point we will provide that guidance list to the department of education and then bring it to this body for approval hoping if we can get a meeting in may we would do that in may and then there's the 30-day period of which we would have to wait to come again in june um and the hope here is that we are able to do this with enough time for divisions to make purchasing decisions if they want to within the next school area so at the conclusion so we

[07:57:49] want to make sure that all that when a child enters a classroom that they are entering a classroom that has a core curriculum that meets the expectation of the law, scientific-based reading research, evidence-based literacy instruction, as defined in the Virginia Literacy Act. We want to make sure that divisions have choice. So we're not the one who's saying you have to use this curriculum, that there is a menu that you can choose from, and we want to be able to provide really good feedback and guidance about what is inside of those curriculum that end up on the list. The intent here is that the rubrics would be not hidden.

[07:58:24] they're publicly available so you can see um you know this this curriculum does really good in these particular areas but if you're going to adopt this one you might need to think about this area in particular so that so that our divisions can be um critical consumers of what they're going to purchase and what they're going to implement and know what they're implementing and then we want to make sure that we are including programs that have been fully vetted there is a provision in the law for um alternative programs but again like i said before if a division wants to use a program that's off the list it's still subject to the same level of review so they

[07:59:03] can ask for that and we would put it through the same review process just as we're doing with the division developed core curriculum i think that's the end of my excellent so one of the things and why we wanted to bring this to this body this month before we actually bring you the approved list is really trying to build a lot of trust and credibility in the process i think one informing you about all of the science and the top research that went into informing the rubric to the level of engagement having folks provide multiple levels of feedback on the rubric itself in addition to

[07:59:42] a competitive process to select the reviewers and then you know engagement like literally reviewers coming scoring coming together having that facilitated by experts having that reviewed by

leadership at vlp leadership at the department and ultimately approved by you because we recognize that this represents a pretty significant shift for the field and so when we do bring you the lists uh around one and round two and potentially future ones to come that we um you can trust in that process and you can kick the tires and ask us tough questions but equally important there

[08:00:20] could be up to 131 division decisions made by school boards across the commonwealth and really wanting to as we've gone out and spoken to superintendents the association of superintendents the school boards association helping them also understand all of the rigor that has gone into this this process so that they when in turn they need to make some of these decisions that they can trust that this is a solid rigorous list that is fully aligned with our our our new state law so that um we are out there sharing this right now and in fact in my over the last three months spoken to

[08:00:56] all i've gone to all of the regional superintendent meetings and really focused on this process noting that they will be the ambassadors of this decision making locally and as dr salari noted and delegate coin or noted this is a decision our obligation and what we will bring to you will be multiple options that are aligned with the law that have a good evidence basis around supporting kids to learn to read but also allow for that important local choice right what one can what might work for one community instead of kids might look different for another so our objective there was just to make sure that you had an understanding of the process when we come back to this group we can talk a little bit more detail any questions you have and then we will bring to you the actual

[08:01:36] list. What questions do you have for Delegate Coiner, Dr. Solari, or myself? And I would say prioritize your questions for Dr. Solari. I do think she's got a... I have a couple of questions.

[08:01:52] I'll just do one now in the interest of prioritizing. We're starting to hear from folks in the IB community and the Montessori community that are concerned about how this is going to affect them. Could you speak to that? Yeah. So I think one of the key things, and we certainly can do some individual engagement in terms of helping folks understand it one of the the the the the rationale and the way that we've set up this process is that there's some very fairly clear black and white rubrics right like these are the things that you should see in a first grade class and a first grade kind of core curriculum these are what you should see in a supplement intervention

[08:02:27] material um we certainly can can probably improve our sharing of the rubrics with folks and having an understanding but the goal would be that anybody can pick this up and look at it and say okay this should be good and then submit my curriculum for review and if not in the same way that we're undergoing with with these the subset of vendors now all right where are the gaps um and how do we address address those gaps and that's the same conversation we've had we recognize the incredible work of virginia school divisions um and for some of our educators who created their own curriculum but the law is very clear that as we define those criteria we have to be consistent

[08:03:04] across the board whether it's school division created commercial vendor montessori but we are certainly willing to take any type of curriculum and review that and our second round will open later this spring dr sorry to miss anything no i think that's right it's similar to how we're working with the divisions you know working with the divisions is different than working with the vendors and so we are providing feedback and support if they do want to continue to use their the the curriculum that they've built and we can certainly do that with other groups as well

[08:03:36] And I may add to that, you know, one of the things when we were developing the bill for the Literacy Act, we reached out to every single school division in the entire state, private schools, public schools, higher education.

[08:03:52] And we had the largest engagement that most education said they had ever seen related to a shift in practice. And, you know, the review of curriculum isn't going to stop right with this first batch, but where we are today, we said anybody who wants to submit curriculum for review, whether homegrown or commercial product can, because we know that folks need to get something in place for the upcoming school year.

[08:04:21] If folks somehow missed, right, the first round, we do need to talk about how we continue going forward with rewashing over curriculum and updating it. that wasn't a that wasn't priority number one right it was to get a strong foundation new curriculum in classrooms but i do think that's something we need to figure out and working um going forward how over the years we continue to review new new curriculum that that comes out and being able to have a review committee that that does this as well as regular updates just

[08:04:51] like we would do with anything else um along the way i just have a process question so if i understand correctly it is the board's board needs to approve the list and the the idea of having a special meeting in may is a lovely idea i just and maybe president gecker has figured out the magic wand how to make it work but from past experience i know how difficult it is with this body to get a quorum scheduling a special meeting so just trying to understand

[08:05:29] what you would be hoping to do would be to bring us the list on first review in may and then for approval in june and it would not work to do first review in june and approval in july that's a problem for the school divisions i see i see that i see miss delegate coiners nod on that so um but if all we need in not all not that it's not significant but if what would be happening in oh and i'm assuming that means you don't think you can get us the list in time for first review in

[08:06:02] April, that is correct. So the first review in February, if it's just first review, it may have less implication for quorum in person versus remote. President Gecker will know that and will help us. We may be able to do more of a virtual meeting, or we may be able to have a quorum here, even if we don't have everybody here. But it may be you want to give us more of an update in April, again if there's things you need all if we can't have all of us here in may and i'm not i'm not

[08:06:38] opposed to the concept of a special meeting i just as i say we've just had a hard time when we tried to do that in the past it's been just really really difficult um um so if we but if there's some way if it's just if it's not a voting uh and that then leads to a second piece of that is I don't mean to ask you to predict the future, but how much potential feedback do you anticipate we'll get from the public or others on the composition of the list? That may, you know,

[08:07:14] how many people have you turned down? Or if that's public information you're able to share, and are we going to get, recognizing you've still got an ongoing appeals process, but is there data you're able to share at this point on how many made it through phase one how many of the total applicants how many have made it through phase two any any any um stargazing or future predicting you're willing to do i i like this new strategy miss holton of multiple questions in one so i like it i like it i like it's a little challenging you're responding but i'm i'm trying to keep track of them so um just a couple of points to note we of course will work very

[08:07:53] closely with with dr mann and and and board chair gecker um we do need to align with the textbook adoption process which requires 30 days between the meetings right that enables uh ease of procurement for local school divisions so that's really important and we've mapped this out so it could be you know june and later but we also know from uh dr siebert's colleagues that the sooner is better um uh in terms of informing local decisions um and uh we posted an update in

[08:08:27] in january to let the field know uh two things one of the commercial vendors who had applied thus far so that gives you a sense of who's applied and who hasn't for k3 and then who had moved on to phase uh two and who had not and i think we had 13 of which 10 moved on um and so that gives you a sense of the universe so for those three that did not move on to phase two as dr salari noted they are not aligned with with the reading and that should be assigned for any school divisions using those

[08:09:04] resources that they face a change for the 10 um we think it would be wise not to uh give you a sense and so we have completed all appeals and i just think there's um obviously you know both wanting to do a very good job of dotting i's and crossing t's and with potential financial implications um being very thoughtful about that and making sure that we follow the process as we put out on our website and when we walk the commercial vendors through that that they were very very clear on that so that you know we're talking about a probably maximum universe of 10 uh somewhere

[08:09:37] around there or a little bit less than that uh for for for the first list two caveats here one is we have not had a public sharing of the school divisions that have reached out we are working quietly with them uh with an understanding of the 2024 implementation and that the goal is to use the rubrics and say this is what the commercial vendors are expected this is the criteria they're expected to meet how can we work with you to recognize where you meet those criteria where there may be gaps and to continually gauge your interest while providing some technical assistance through the ELP to see whether you want to continue to develop and build this out

[08:10:16] so that your curriculum can meet the same criteria. Obviously that's a bit more sensitive and involves some back and forth and so we're doing that more privately and then we'll bring that to the board on a more rolling basis as we go forward. The other caveat that I want to note is as we see with the expansion that that that tactically shifts some of the decision making for local school divisions as they're thinking about do I want to pick something from this list or might I want to see until a broader K-5 list comes out, right? Many of our of our structures

[08:10:55] for elementary school are more often K-5 than K-3. And we would need to, even for the approved resources, create a 4-5 rubric, review those kind of different grade bands, right? And again, we can share these rubrics. They are very specific down to the grade band, because what you want for kindergartners, right, looks very different from third grade, right, and fifth grade. And really, each of them has to be fully aligned with the science. Each of them, when Dr. Solari described this was reviewed by virginia educators virginia higher ed national expert like these these um are very important for each grade band and so when we put out this list we are also going to prepare a

[08:11:33] toolkit for thinking about curriculum implication but we understand that the second we put out this list folks will say well when is the second list going to come right because now we are uh thanks to the the work of our general assembly um you know now thinking about four or five in addition to that right and there are some resources i know when we've shared the status update folks have said desk well if i don't see my curriculum on there is that a bad sign it's a no sign right it just means that your vendor didn't

submit this round and so there's just a lot that are going to come in in round two so what maybe this is much longer answer to your question miss holton than expected but what we're really doing is we want to get something out there probably as much for folks

[08:12:13] who are using these resources right now so they can say all right i'm good right like you came through you're approved i'm good to go i'm going to focus on some other elements of the law and then we will have to turn quickly, and we are preparing for this, to run a second round, to be completely exhaustive, to Mr. Rotherham's point, about all of those things that are being used in Virginia now, because we will want to get that list to you by the end of this calendar year, so that there's an, or, you know, into early next year, so that within advance of the 2024 fall implementation date,

[08:12:47] that we've got a solid K-5, four curriculum, K-8 supplement and intervention. That is what we've believe we've really given folks two cuts to the apple to get to us all of the resources that might be currently used in Virginia classrooms. So we want to move this along as fast as possible while obviously we'll work with Mr. Gecker and Dr. Mann, but also know that the second round will be incredibly important as well. Just very specifically, just looking at if I'm hearing not only we're hearing first review and second review, but that there is a textbook

[08:13:24] requirement that those do be 30 days apart. So our June meeting is relatively early. It's June 14, 15. So if you're telling us you're not ready by April 19th, but we would need to meet in the, you know, between May 1st and May 14th, something like that. And I hope if we're not able to find a date that works for everybody, you all don't take it as a on of our lack of interest in your important topic. It's just...

[08:13:55] No, it is the hardest thing we do. It is. I mean, it's like, how could it possibly do? It is a matter of days in terms of, you know, and we've looked at every element of the Gantt chart, and if we could get it to you in April, we would. And I also just want to do a shout out to Virginia Literacy Partners, but these 36 reviewers worked through Thanksgiving, worked through the winter holiday. If you're listening right now have just done extraordinary work we have i think increased the stipend twice because of just the level of work and so um you know making sure it's this incredibly tenuous balancing act i

[08:14:32] think when i presented to dr siebert's colleagues there was actually groaning in the room that it wasn't coming sooner and i was sort of balancing that between our incredible reviewers our staff and the uva staff who are working around the clock but we we it's a game of inches and we will we will the best we can to kind of balance all these priorities delegate i think to add um to those points um they have done everything they can to move as fast as possible and i would say i think the a few walls that we're running up against which is why you know i would beg do everything you can to find a date to come together you know the only piece of the literacy act the

[08:15:09] state did not fund was the purchase of curriculum because our school division still had covid money and this was a good use of those funds to revamp curriculum and they're running up against deadlines they're also going to run up against choices if they happen to see that the list you all finally approved their curriculum is already on it they're not no longer having to wait on holding that money they can go spend it on other learning loss initiatives so the longer we wait the longer it takes to get learning loss items in the hands of our elementary school folks and the last piece of that putting on my former school board member hat um while yes you are going to

[08:15:45] hear from some folks who may be unhappy that their curriculum isn't on the first list um you know the real work will be for school divisions who are going to publicly review the choices and have to

work within their local communities to hold public meetings to pick one and that's actually i think probably a much tougher process um to decide on one um for them just and not putting them in a time crunch as well so um i do think you're gonna hear back from folks just because you know when we did sort of a non-scientific review of what people were using across virginia

[08:16:22] the vast majority of classrooms do not have curriculums that are teaching kids to learn to read so if you think about the vast majority of classrooms are going to have to have new curriculum in place change is hard so we're going to hear from folks and we were prepared for that when we took these steps two years ago to decide um we were going to walk this journey together to improve reading for kids so i hope that sort of compliments are you going to hear back from people i think the honest answer is yes um but at the end of the day we will know that what they have in their hands will make for much happier teachers and students and parents when we see kids reading at the end

[08:16:57] of the day so give you my word we are going to make it happen yes my question was under the review teams i thought i heard arkansas or was it alaska do you look up to rubric we we engaged with colorado arkansas um and actually rhode island on this yeah okay um as i was looking at the screen it threw me off i saw ak and i thought that was alaska all right arkansas thank you thank you so pick a couple things first of all this is super exciting and and i think it's a really big step

[08:17:35] for it for the problem you identified i do think just it's really important that we do hammer on this idea that this is the first review there's gonna be multiple reviews there's i mean we're i'm not telling you anything you don't know it's a kind of you know people it's a little hopped up out there and so people for example we we made a uh you know we made a commitment in in the history standards contained a commitment that we're going to make sure the school division should provide high quality instructional materials to teachers which is a very pro teacher move that many other states are taking that's been interpreted as some sort of a restriction right which is obviously the plain language of it makes clear that's not the case but nonetheless that that sort of is out

[08:18:13] there we'll have the same thing here if we're not if we don't message that there's going to be more that this is this first round and we've seen this in other states will be viewed as sort of this is it and you're on or you're off and so i think it's really important to message ongoing process both the grade levels but also um uh that there's going to be additional review processes and so forth um not that we're going to lower the standards but just that this is not the only this is not the only time to get on or off the train um my other question though like i'm just curious i i hear i agree with my colleague miss holdman the logistics of scheduling is going to be a challenge how many school divisions are going to adopt a new curriculum at this point

[08:18:52] and implement it this fall like i'm a little confused about the i mean most of them have made these decisions and our planning and all of that just given the timeline it takes to do something like that well so i'm struggling a little bit with like this deadline is it is it statutory or is it like that we couldn't just do this at two regular meetings so i can answer a little bit of that one you have some school divisions that are in their regular where they have to purchase new curriculum in their cycle and they are at emergency mode waiting on us to give them that

[08:19:26] Two, they have dollars that have to be spent, and so if they're not, and they're holding it for this purpose because they know that if they need to buy new, so there's a deadline with that money being spent, and then the statute does require that everything is in the classrooms in 24-25, but we're going to go

ahead and start training all the reading specialists, and so they really need to know what they're going to be using, even if it's not in the classroom at that point in time, to align the work that they're doing.

[08:19:54] so i'll let my colleagues here add to that the other only point that i i would make andy is that when we did this first review we went out to school divisions said what are you using right so this is not just a subset of a random 13 right these are ones that are in play now and so in some ways there's a subset of folks who are using totally different things who are probably going to rate wait for both rounds right and we're going to want to pick k5 the whole gamut there's there's a whole bunch of folks out there who are using the things that are on that list right and And so us coming back and saying thumbs up or thumbs down, I think is important for their decision making, even going into 23-24.

[08:20:33] And probably their 23-24 looks very different if they know that beginning of the summer versus the fall. Again, noting that some of those relief dollars are a 930 date. August would still be or July would still be before 930, but it just continues to trim that window.

[08:20:52] I think that's important. These are recommendations that came from currently being used resources. Well, and I think the worry, if you said you looked across the Commonwealth to find out what people were using, and you didn't get a very favorable answer that people are using anything, the thought that we would want another year to go by before people are actually leveraging resources that could help address learning loss and just helping to make sure children are, again, being exposed to resources that help them make progress.

[08:21:29] I just, I think it's incumbent upon us to find a way to get this done. I think the work that you all have presented to us reflects an incredible amount of diligence and effort. And I think we can figure out a way to try and meet you where you need to be met so that we can ensure children have access to high quality learning materials to support their learning.

[08:21:58] I was really curious on the rubric front, and I know this wouldn't necessarily be a requirement, but I'm curious in your review of materials, did you discover there were resources that could help bridge school with home, the extent to which there were resources that teachers could easily leverage to share with parents so that there is this school to home bridge connection that doesn't leave parents, kind of, you know, I know my child could benefit from, you know, support.

[08:22:32] How do I do that, so? - I can speak that a little bit. I mean, it's not super common that a core ELA curriculum would have materials like that. But a part of the act is that we are engaging families around literacy and evidence-based literacy instruction.

[08:22:49] And one of the parts of the work that Jenna did not speak to that our office is taking on is developing those vetted resources for families that will walk alongside all the PD that we're doing for teachers, the evidence-based literacy instruction and the content of core instruction in the context of the classroom.

[08:23:07] So it is not very, there are some aspects that might be like, this is how you talk to your parent, a parent about literacy, but it's not those high quality materials that we would necessarily want to send home with families. but that is a part of the law and we are developing those materials right now.

[08:23:24] And I think one of the things that we've uncovered through supporting this implementation and our collaborative work on the screener is when you talk about family resources, really thinking about what that is and how do you individualize that to the child. And that one, for instance, or example is as a

department, my understanding is we've had a various different set of positions on sharing the PALS results. So I'll use the former name of the screener. And if you go out there and you go to an elementary school playground right now and ask all the parents, you know, how did you get the PALS results? You will, if you ask 20 parents, you'll get 20

[08:23:59] different answers in terms of, okay, I got it. I was able to understand it. Actually, they just sent home the sheet that the teacher gave and there's all these terms. I know when I have to text Emily to say, what does this mean? Like that's a proxy for a much bigger problem in terms of parent engagement um so what we're we're trying to do dr mann is to take the requirement of the law which says resources and be really thoughtful about curriculum assessment screener you know teacher reading specialist how are we not only getting out sort of generally good research you know resources around reading and its importance and how to support it but like what does it

[08:24:35] individually mean when your kid is struggling in decoding versus language right and how do you how How do we do a better job supporting the system to engage families in that way? Because again, the other thing that I have to talk about is that being above the PALS benchmark is perceived as being an A. That's not actually what it's an indicator of.

[08:24:55] Below the PALS benchmark means that serious risk. And the parents, I said, oh, my kid is good. They got PALS. And I'm always like, well, how above the PALS benchmark is that? But I just realized that's a real indictment of us systematically in terms of really thinking about what does this mean and how quickly Benchmark became a proxy for A versus just the proxy for not at great risk.

[08:25:18] And that indicates to us, when we've asked ourselves a question, what will be different for classrooms as of 2024, what will be different for students, what will be different for families? We have to think of it comprehensively rather than just like, oh, this is what the line in the law says, and therefore there is a website with family resources.

[08:25:33] Oh, I think that's very important. It was clear in the rubric that parents were mentioned as a part of the law, but it's often hard for parents to really sort of get what they need to be that bridge in supporting their children's learning.

[08:25:50] So I'm really happy to hear that you all are focusing on that. I think the department has done a really nice job enriching the website in a way that makes it a lot more user-friendly for resources. And so kudos on that front.

[08:26:08] should also note to your to your points dr man and yours we also recognize we need some for some hearts and minds communication work and so we're looking at i think really i don't want to underestimate what delegate koiner said in terms of the local lift lift around making sure you engage all of your community constituents and choices around curriculum and other resources also helping teachers understand the why i've been talking with dr siebert's colleagues like this is a lot for elementary school teachers what are we going to take away how are we going to prepare them and making sure that across the system, the why is very clear. Because I do think this is a thing, you know, this was a bipartisan, unanimous law, right? So I'm sort of really

[08:26:47] supported by a broad set of constituents, but it's still a big lift. And we have our work cut out for us, making sure that we can get this word out there, that folks understand this, can buy into it. Dr. Manu and I worked on a similar work in early childhood. It really, if people locally believe in the why, I think it

makes a lot of this decision-making and change management more doable, and we take that responsibility very seriously. Yes. So just thank you, thank you. Really very, very good, great progress. We are very, very fortunate in the Commonwealth of Virginia to have Dr. Solari and UVA and this wealth of research, and even though PALS is being renamed,

[08:27:26] this is not new, this is anchoring in Virginia very, very good. My urging would be, to the extent possible as we take pd to scale not just to bring people up to date right away but understanding this is an ongoing pipeline of training and retraining and new people etc so many so many school divisions rely on the higher education institutions in their backyard and so to the extent to which um the the colleagues from other higher education institutions can be brought to bear it's just going to put many more foot soldiers out there and so we how i know i know you're always giving thought to it but we need to really figure out how we we can engage and bring

[08:28:04] that online it's going to bring a whole lot more pd to bear specifically i was in a meeting a couple weeks ago three to six and seven superintendents and and they were just like you know this is great but we we have people nearby we we need we need training right away so we just need to engage other institutions yeah we just met right just a few weeks ago with all of the the deans of the ed schools across the commonwealth and i think one of the things that we can share actually at a future work session with you all is our design for training is really focused on sustainability and redundancy and thinking about how we can get a lot of folks involved in it what kind of train

[08:28:40] the trainer models we can use but we take that very seriously well dr super when you mentioned that it just made me think about higher ed prep period it's also just where is this in higher ed teacher prep because we've got to find a way to make sure those loops are happening right it's painful to come out of school and you've spent all this money and you've you know passed the praxis and you've been licensed and oh boy i don't have what i need to be able to actually teach

[08:29:11] children how to read it's so i think that's part of it um and that's my next question is that's a good springboard there to my next question and that was another piece that uh delegate coiner was describing as a need for help so what i would like to ask her to do is to describe that exact thing that you're talking about how are we getting our our students who are in our epps prepared and then how are we preparing those who want to go deeper who are already in our classrooms so that's going to be looking at that micro credentialing as well as the licensing piece

[08:29:49] so i'd like for her to expand upon that statement she had earlier sure i'm going to answer both hopefully at the same time um so in looking at higher ed we did engage two and a half years ago with with our our deans or with folks from the universities centered around developing in the literacy act the one area that we really needed to provide to them is the guidance and direction on what are our expectations as a state for teachers who receive a degree and then go into our classroom and so we met last march to start talking about with the department what that

[08:30:28] micro credential needed to look like and the micro credential was never meant as a separate endorsement separate thing it's a stepping stone to get your reading specialist credential it was meant as a way to encourage good teachers to be willing to get on that path to become a reading specialist and to take the pressure valve off of school divisions that didn't have enough already licensed reading specialists but they had someone who had some minimal requirements that we felt filled that need so we we on one you know really need to put put that out there and in

[08:31:07] place. That's something that also has to come before you all so that all of our teacher prep programs can go ahead and start jumping on board to getting our reading specialists ready. And then that they can help us with that pipeline of reading specialists. So that's number one. The second part, so that's that answer. The second part going just to our classroom teachers, right? So that's not the micro-credential reading specialist issue, which we do have and that needs to be addressed very quickly um you know we had some honest conversations with deans about the autonomy

[08:31:41] of professors within schools needing to be reined in for the benefit of children in virginia and i'm the politician so i can say that you know other people in the education world may not want to but at the end of the day you know we've given a lot of autonomy but the professors who are in our schools of education are responsible for ensuring that ever every teacher that leaves their program if you're going to be an elementary school teacher that children can read and it is not consistently being done in higher ed across virginia today and so you know it's really a call

[08:32:16] to our deans to lead their schools of education and bring their professors together and say there's a whole lot of areas you can have autonomy and within this body of work just like we gave you a variety of curriculum lists right there are things that you can you can do that make you you different than other people, but we're all going to have our basis in scientifically based reading research practices and how we're preparing. Because if you look at our teacher retention, right, our teacher retention issue, if your kids aren't learning, teachers told us, I am so frustrated because I'm doing everything I was taught and my kids still aren't being where

[08:32:52] I need them to be. That is hard when the thing you went in to do for a living is to teach children to read if you're a k-3 teacher it's fundamental so we are really going to make it i think it's going to solve a lot of our younger grade teacher retention issues if we can have them better prepared but it's going to take some serious conversations across the state and higher ed we had a great meeting with the deans last week they um they were able to meet with all of us and the secretary was there as well um and i had a great follow-up meeting actually today with dean of education at JMU he happened to be in town and we were able to chat and he's excited about it

[08:33:30] but it's hard work and I will say it's even harder work with how many new deans we have in Virginia and it's hard to be a new dean and that is not lost on me so I think we all within the state system can help with the pushback that's going to come from a little bit of loss of autonomy in some of these areas thank you so much for that answer it's very important to go to the heart of the matter sometimes other questions awesome well we really do appreciate you thank you all thank

[08:34:06] you very much thank you and i think then that means it's 4 27 and there is not another thing on the agenda so we get to go and have free time before dinner correct dinner is noticed for six o'clock at the hard show six thirty six thirty

[08:34:32] you've got an extra 6 30. i stand corrected andy what's the name of the hotel



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